

FINAL REPORT
Fourteenth Annual Meeting
of the
General Service Conference
of
Alcoholics Anonymous

Roosevelt Hotel, New York City

April 21-26, 1964



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1964 FINAL REPORT

Fourteenth Annual Meeting General Service Conference of A.A.

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CONFERENCE AT A GLANCE

'Practicing These Principles' Is Conference Theme

14th Meeting Studies A.A. Responsibilities

The Fourteenth Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous, at the Roosevelt Hotel in New York City, was the first to cover a six-day span.

From Tuesday, April 21, through part of Sunday, the 26th, a total of more than 120 Area Delegates, Trustees, Overseas Observers and General Service Office Staff Members shared their "experience, hope and strength" to assure the survival of A.A.'s Third Legacy of Service to each other — and to those who may seek help in future days.

Among other "Advisory Actions," the Conference:

GENERAL SERVICE OFFICE

Approved a new filmstrip describing world services made available through G.S.O.

Approved a plan to send G.S.O. correspondence exclusively to General Service Representatives in certain Areas where this distribution method will be tested.

Approved preliminary results of the Monthly Sharing Plan (regular monthly contributions) in Areas where the Plan is now being tested.

Recorded complete confidence in the operations of G.S.O. and approval of present patterns of compensation for Staff Members.

Recommended that the General Service Board consider a pension plan for G.S.O.

Recommended that the present pattern of book discounts (whereby the Groups have waived a portion of their discount to permit creation of an adequate Reserve Fund) be continued until next year.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Approved a formal statement defining A.A.'s position in the field of alcoholism.

Urged Delegates and Committee Members to establish communications with other agencies who share A.A.'s concern in this field.

TRUSTEES

Deferred decision on a suggestion that non-alcoholic Trustees of the General Service Board be "rotated," pending receipt of a report and recommendations from the Chairman of the Board.

Approved the nomination of Murray W. as a Class B (General Service) Trustee.

Approved the nomination of Bruce M. of Ohio to fill the vacancy created by the death of Class B (Regional) Trustee Howard B.

THE FELLOWSHIP OF A.A.

Based on reports to G.S.O., Spring 1964

	Groups	Members
United States.....	7,033	122,483
Canada.....	1,075	15,410
Overseas.....	1,690	32,071
In Hospitals.....	514	11,417
In Prisons.....	644	27,753
Internationalists..	—	300
Lone Members.....	—	(720)*
Totals	10,956	209,434

(Including "non-reported" members, actual membership is estimated at more than 350,000.)

*These members included in Area totals.

ADMISSIONS

Recommended that a second Delegate be admitted from the Atlantic Provinces of Canada.

Tabled, for future consideration, requests from the state of Indiana and the province of Ontario for additional Delegates.

CONFERENCE

Recommended that the 1965 Conference cover a six-day period.

Approved strengthening the Conference committee structure, to provide expanded opportunities for service by Delegates.

TORONTO CONVENTION

Approved operating plans and procedures for the 30th Anniversary International Convention in Toronto July 2-3-4, 1965 and expressed confidence that it will be well supported.

Toronto Convention Plans Approved

INTERNATIONAL

Approved a recommendation of the International Committee of the G.S.B. that an experimental "workshop" on A.A. structure and services be conducted at G.S.O. for locally selected representatives of A.A. in Latin America.

GRAPEVINE

Approved making the Conference Committee on the Grapevine "an active part of the Grapevine effort."

Approved further study of a proposed French-language "Grapevine."

Approved appropriate steps to protect the "Grapevine's" interest in copyright material, short of engagement in public controversy.

LITERATURE

Approved special identifying phrases for Conference-approved A.A. literature and reprints of other material distributed with Conference approval.

Recommended preparation of a special "small format" edition of "The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions."

Recommended further study of a proposal to prepare a pamphlet for use at beginners and newcomers meetings.

BILL

Reviewed and approved an agreement between Bill W., co-founder, and A.A. World Services, Inc., covering royalties derived from Bill's writings. (The intent of the agreement is to protect Bill, his wife, Lois, and their designated heirs, while defining A.A.W.S.'s position as the Society's publishing agency.)

PROXIES

Agreed that, in general, it was not advisable to accept proxies from regular groups at A.A. Assembly meetings.

"AREA DELEGATES ONLY" MEETING

As is traditional at Conferences, one evening session was devoted to a meeting exclusively for Area Delegates. All other Conference members were excluded. Ruby B., SE Texas Delegate, chaired the 1964 meeting. Claude M., Alaska, was elected chairman of the 1965 meeting.

THE SENSE OF THE CONFERENCE

'Sharing' Was Dominant Mood of the Meeting

"Alcoholics Anonymous is a fellowship of men and women who share . . ."

Those are the opening words of the capsule description of A. A. that has come to be known as the A.A. preamble. They can be used with particular appropriateness to describe the spirit of the fourteenth annual meeting of the General Service Conference of A.A. that met over a period of six days in the Roosevelt Hotel in New York City late in April of 1964.

"Sharing" was almost certainly the dominant mood of the meeting. Earlier Conferences had of course been dedicated to the concept of sharing. But, to many observers, it seemed that the 1964 Conference Delegates practiced "sharing" to an unprecedented degree. More than that, the Delegates' reports of A.A. activities in their Areas reflected unusual awareness of the value of "sharing" in Group, Intergroup and Area affairs.

Willing to Share Responsibility

What was shared?

Experience, primarily, but this was not all. Again and again during the Conference there was evidence that the 1964 Delegates, almost without exception, were eager to share larger burdens of responsibility for A.A.'s Third Legacy of Service. This was not simply a matter of conventional exhortations to drum up increased financial support for G.S.O. back home. The 1964 Conference was a body that asked for work while it was in New York, as evidenced by the substantial amount of time spent in committee deliberations, and asked that it be given specific work assignments during the coming year.

The spirit of sharing was apparent through the meeting. It underlay the joint deliberations of General Service Board and Conference Committees. It was apparent in the several projects designed to improve communications between G. S. O. and the Areas and among Conference Committeemen themselves. And it was clearly the motivation behind plans to help advance the orderly growth of Traditional A.A. overseas.

Paralleling the spirit of sharing there appeared to be a special sense of discovery. It was as if the active practice of sharing had revealed rich veins of experience that the movement had not realized it possessed. In describing experience with "Sharing Sessions" in their home Areas, a number of Delegates remarked that they were amazed to note how many worthwhile suggestions for improving A. A.'s services to alcoholics had developed.

Will Strengthen Unity of A. A.

Unquestionably, this increasing interest in sharing will serve to strengthen the unity of Traditional A.A., providing stronger foundations for the sobriety of individual members. Groups in which members share their experience, strength and hope are Groups which offer the greatest support to the recovered alcoholic. Areas in which Groups share their successes and fail-

ures in the practice of Traditional A.A. are likely to be Areas in which the Society's unique capabilities and weaknesses are clearly understood by other agencies and by the general public. And experience shared internationally offers the best prospect that the A.A. message will not be distorted, regardless of the language in which it may be carried.

Through its emphasis on sharing, the fourteenth General Service Conference offered a modest but effective rebuttal to any suggestion that A.A. may be becoming a rigid or dogmatic cult. There is nothing negative or withdrawn in the kind of sharing dramatized by the Conference. Rather, sharing is regarded as an approach to the correction of weaknesses, as a method for projecting constructive principles and practices and as a technique for letting the outside world see clearly what A.A. is and what it offers the problem drinker.

The concept of sharing is as old as A.A. itself. But the 1964 Conference gave it new vitality and special meaning in the light of the problems and opportunities confronting the Society today. Equally important, by its spirit and its actions the Conference reminded all who share the gift of sobriety:

"Alcoholics Anonymous is a *fellowship* . . ."

30th Anniversary International Convention of A.A.

July 1-3, 1965

Toronto

Canada

INDIVIDUAL HAS RESPONSIBILITIES, BILL NOTES

In a brief but moving talk at Sunday morning's closing session of the Conference, Bill W., surviving co-founder of Alcoholics Anonymous, reminded Delegates of the individual A.A. member's responsibilities for his own development and growth and for that of the Society as a whole.

We are propelled to this Society by the threat of death itself by alcoholism, Bill suggested. "But when we have acquired a little grace and some of the mist has passed from our eyes, we find ourselves in a new world. We also find that we are faced with immense responsibilities; for our own growth and development, for the welfare of our Group, for the welfare of A.A. as a whole, for better homes, for better relations with the world around us.

"We are met with all these vast responsibilities and of course we recoil and we rebel. But little by little, prodded from behind by John Barleycorn and drawn by the love we feel here and by the love of God, we pick up the tab for a little more responsibility.

A Step Toward Maturity

"This is not maturity; this is just a step toward that distant goal.

"Sometimes we pick up these tabs rather unwilling because it seems the right thing to do. But finally we conform to these principles and their practice in all our affairs because this is really what we want for ourselves . . . not just because John Barleycorn is going to kill us off if we don't conform, not just because the A.A. community says they are right, but because we want them for ourselves.

"My mind goes back to the early days of A.A. and I think how valuable to us is the sense of history. But, like all things of value, it can be misused. Let us not suppose that we have all the requisites, else the past will lay a dead hand on us."

Bill quoted the "Warranties of the General Service Conference" adopted by the movement at St. Louis in 1955. "These are," he said, "really in broad brush strokes the measure of several and selective responsibilities, responsibilities which I feel the fourteenth Conference has met magnificently. They are responsibilities which do not entitle us to call ourselves mature, but which do entitle us to say that we have arrived at the age of full responsibility."

Recalls Conference Development

Earlier at the opening Conference dinner Tuesday night, Bill had described A.A. as a body of beliefs (The Twelve Suggested Steps) and attitudes (The Twelve Traditions). He recalled how the first members, along with helpful nonalcoholic friends had discharged responsibilities for A.A.'s growth as "trusted servants" of the movement. By 1950 it was recognized that there had been a reversal in the "current of authority" in A.A., Bill said, and the Conference, "called in great trepidation," symbolized the transfer of responsibility for A.A.'s services to the movement as a whole. A trusted servant, he declared, is not a "trusted housemaid" but "a person who is capable of taking those decisions in your behalf that he thinks you would take yourself if you had all the facts about a situation."

HUMILITY AND REALISM NEEDED, DR. NORRIS SAYS

Among the most thoughtful and stimulating talks at the 1964 Conference were two by the same person, Dr. John L. Norris, nonalcoholic Chairman of A.A.'s General Service Board and, in "civilian" life, Associate Medical Director of Eastman Kodak Company in Rochester.

Dr. Jack spoke at both the pre-Conference get-together of Delegates on Tuesday and at the closing session Sunday morning. Both messages were related to the same theme: A.A. as a movement should remain humble and realistic about its services to alcoholics and should not be afraid to take its own inventory — or have it taken by others.

"We need to have other people take our inventory," Dr. Jack said. "All of us have blind spots and if we are aware of some of them, and sufficiently mature to accept someone else's inventory of us, we will grow and fill out some of our weaknesses.

"One of our jobs at this Conference is to take inventory of the movement. We have had some help on this lately. We are rather grateful that this happened, that someone — friendly or not — spoke up and pointed out to us some of the spots where, some of the time at least, we might do a better job."

Noting that some observers had asserted that A.A. is becoming rigid — that we have a dogma," Dr. Jack pointed out that whether or not certain traditional practices in A.A. become dogmatic "depends on us."

If A.A. members, "who have suffered so much from the moral judgments of other people," turn moral judgment on others, the accusation of rigidity and dogma can be a justified accusation, he pointed out.

The G.S.B. Chairman said he sometimes became "a little frustrated and discouraged" when he considered the number of people A.A. is not able to help, the number of medical schools and physicians who do not understand the alcoholic and alcoholism, and the number of social workers who still do not understand alcoholism.

"Yet I think back to the situation 20 years ago and I realize that we have made tremendous progress," he said. "We need patience and we need faith. As we say the Serenity Prayer, we ask for the ability to 'accept the things we cannot change, the courage to change the things we can, and the wisdom to know the difference.' Along with these things comes persistence. If the things we think we want today are right, in their own good time they will happen. It is when we identify ourselves with our ideas, and feel that a criticism of our ideas is an attack on us, that argument comes in and productive discussion goes out."

Dr. Jack said he hoped Delegates would continue to be concerned with A.A.'s failures as well as its successes. Specifically, he suggested that the quality of sponsorship didn't seem to be "quite what it used to be."

We must constantly work to maintain the "one-to-one" relationship in A.A., Dr. Jack reminded his hearers. "If we lose this, we begin to die."

Both the Conference and A.A. as a movement can be subject to the hazard of "feeling that we have the answers," the Chairman pointed out.

"I hope we never have all the answers," he said, "and I'm sure we won't because we are dealing with life. And life, whenever we try to define it, whenever we try to box it in, is always too big for the box we have made."

Dr. Jack said one of the most valuable contributions Delegates could make to the Conference next year would be to "think about the things we have missed this week" and report them to G.S.O.

"It is only as you people at the Group level see problems and tell us about them that we can be aware of our blind spots and do a better job at G.S.O. of serving you and preserving, for those who don't yet know the privilege, the joy of honesty and service which is A.A."

THE CONFERENCE TAKES ITS INVENTORY

A distinguishing feature of A.A.'s as individuals and as a Society is their general willingness to "take inventory," to face facts about themselves and to take steps to correct situations that may require changing.

The special presentation, "The Conference Takes Its Inventory," was one of the most stimulating sessions offered at the 1964 Conference. Highlights of the comments of the four participants may be summarized as follows:

Clyde Davis (S. California) "How Are We Doing As Delegates?"

Clyde reviewed the two primary duties of Delegates, as outlined in the Third Legacy Manual:

1. To consider issues raised . . . and to vote intelligently upon them so as to provide guidance to the G.S.B.
2. To get a clear picture of G.S.O. and carry that back home to inform the membership in the Areas.

Year after year, at Conferences, the same topics come up for discussion, Clyde pointed out. He suggested that this may be because Delegates fail to inform their successors adequately, or because new Delegates do not study the "wealth of material" of a background nature sent to them before they reach New York.

Questions '\$3 Yardstick'

Clyde questioned the wisdom of continuing to use the "\$3.00 per member per year" concept as a yardstick in discussions of financial support for G.S.O. "Better results might be obtained by emphasizing that a meager 15 per cent of our expense is for administration of services while a whopping 85 per cent goes directly into services rendered," he said. The average fund-raising operation in the U.S., he said, involves about 40 per cent of the funds for administration.

The California Delegate suggested more stress should be laid on "the tremendous increase in total services rendered since 1944, with very little increase in the average cost per Group of those expanded services."

There are three roles a Delegate should fulfill, he pointed out: (1) As communicators, (2) As people responsible for the smooth running of G.S.O., including adequate financial support, and (3) Partnership in the custody of the Three Legacies of Service.

Bob Ryder (S. Florida) "How An Area Committee Helps Build Local Services"

Although A.A. had been active in Broward County in South Florida for 20 years, there had not been "organized direction" in the General Service Committee or Intergroup aspects of the program until recently, Bob reported.

The first project of the Area Committee, early in 1963, was to schedule monthly meetings of G.S.R.'s and Committee Members. These were generally well attended and a noticeable interest in inter-community Twelfth Step work developed. The advantages of a Central Office or Intergroup were explained to local A.A.'s by the Area Committee and local Groups were encouraged to elect Intergroup representatives.

Within a short period an Intergroup structure had been created and enough financial support was available to support a modest Intergroup office, staffed by volunteers six days a week. The first annual Intergroup banquet commemorating the 20th anniversary of A.A. in Broward County helped to unify A.A. in the county and brought in additional funds for office operations.

G.S.R.'s have continued to be effective two-way communicators between their Groups and the Area Committee monthly meetings.

Everett Kronlund (Washington) "Strengthening A.A. by Helping Its Weaker Groups"

Even making allowances for Groups that are doomed to fail from the start, the deactivation of 503 Groups in a single year suggests that "We are not doing the job we should be doing in helping the new and weaker Groups to get on a solid footing," Everett pointed out.

The ideal time to help a new Group, he said, is when it is being formed and when certain basic needs can be emphasized:

1. Selection of a capable Secretary and a responsible Treasurer
2. Avoidance of "high rent" meeting places
3. Continuing zeal in accepting and following through on Twelfth Step calls.
4. Immediate participation in Intergroup and Third Legacy affairs
5. Acceptance of responsibility for institutional A.A.

Many weaker Groups, particularly in smaller communities, can be helped by scheduling as many large state gatherings as possible in those communities, Everett said, citing successful experience of this kind in the State of Washington.

Bill Coldeway (Utah) "A. A. Protects Its Service Responsibilities"

When outside agencies in the field of alcoholism move ahead on issues that involve A.A., it is frequently because A.A. itself did not, or has not attempted, to provide certain services, Bill declared.

In Utah today, A.A. has excellent cooperation with outside agencies and "Any and all problems normally can be cleared up by the exercise of common sense, discussion and a willingness to share ideas and information pertinent to our common cause," he pointed out. Earlier, some people in and close to A. A. did move forward to create boards and foundations and other agencies while A.A. as a movement seemingly stood by, "blinded by misinterpretation of Traditions and, in some cases, lack of knowledge."

A.A. can protect and project its services in four ways, Bill suggested: (1) Create a strong State Service Committee, (2) Set up a State Central Office offering more direct service to A.A.'s and effective liaison with outside agencies, (3) Schedule "Sharing Sessions" on local and world services, and (4) Sustain the Delegate to the General Service Conference meeting for three years, rather than two.

Further Study On "Study Guides"

In recent years there have been recurring requests that G.S.O. prepare special material in the form of "Study Guides" that might be used by Beginners' Groups and so-called "Study Groups." The 1963 Conference had considered a specific proposal that "Study Guides" to the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions be prepared but had merely referred the subject to the Conference Literature Committee for possible action this year.

This Committee, in turn, had recorded its "feeling" that the book itself was a study guide. It also suggested that the sub-

ject be discussed again during the 1964 Conference.

Comments by 1964 Delegates disclosed that such guides are used in a number of Areas and are considered to be useful, particularly in new Groups. The proposal for a G.S.O.-sponsored study guide pamphlet was again referred to the Conference Literature Committee for further study, with the suggestion that Delegates from Areas in which such material is used send 24 copies of each guide to G.S.O. for review. The material would be submitted to members of both the Board and Conference Literature committees.

AREA, STATE AND REGIONAL CONFERENCES

One of the major presentations at the 1964 General Service Conference was a session that explored in depth the subject of Area, State and Regional A.A. Conferences. Six speakers offered facts, opinions and suggestions that added up to a full-scale analysis of the subject.

Delegate Larry Ferguson of Oklahoma, leading off with the topic, "How can such Conferences serve A.A. welfare," pointed out that such gatherings are important in creating an "image" of A.A. not only in the minds of nonalcoholics but also in the minds of members and prospective members.

"All that we do, in great measure, reflects what we are," Larry said. "Each of us, and all of us, are examples, good or bad."

He suggested that Conference, Program and Speakers' committees should try to assure "balance" in meetings entrusted to them: balance with adequate provision for reference to all three Legacies; balance involving proportionate emphasis on information, inspiration and dedication; balance as to representation of Groups, districts, Areas and national and world service functions.

"Harsh as the term is," Larry pointed out, "it would be wise, it seems to me, to blacklist virtually all 'lay preachers,' volunteer evangelists, crusaders, and self-appointed 'semi-professionals' and to look with some suspicion upon all self-appointed 'specialists.'"

Three speakers discussed "What I Like and Don't like About Area Get-togethers."

'Best Lines of Communication'

Regional Trustee Tom Sharpe reminded the Delegates that in the early days of A.A. Area meetings were the best lines of communication and are still "very valuable in that respect today."

Tom cautioned against "loading the sessions and program and making the individual meetings too long." He also suggested that at times one city, Area or state may try to "out-do" another one, "which leads to too much programming, too many 'name' speakers and general loading of the program."

Regional Trustee Dave Bancroft said that he did not believe that the program is the most important thing at any Conference. "There is something else," he said. "It's a sort of Conference atmosphere of wonderful fellowship." Some talks or panel sessions on A.A. services draw a smaller attendance than others ("but of really dedicated members") and deserve a place on a program, "but not too big a one," Dave noted.

A meeting on the theme, "As Others See Us," can be enlightening if the speakers are selected carefully and have diverse approaches, he said. "Every once in a while we will get a speaker who'll stop us short in our tracks," he declared. "It seems to me that how we accept criticism is to a large degree a

measure of our maturity, both as individuals and as a Society. I think this type of meeting is most important at any regional Conference."

Harold Frederick, Ontario Delegate, (absent but represented by his Alternate, Blake Livingstone) pointed out that one of the things he did not like about Area get-togethers was "last minute programming." When committees wait too long to set up their programs, they are often unable to get the speakers and panelists they would have liked to schedule, his paper noted. "I don't like a Conference where the programming committee persists in using long-winded chairmen. If one wants to hear the chairman, make *him* the speaker. We learn in A.A. that some are great speakers, some are panelists, some are chairmen, some can do almost anything — and some won't work," he commented.

Change Pace of Programs

George Mills, Northeastern Ohio Delegate, outlined "How We Share Responsibility for Area Conferences in our State." He said that Ohio Conferences have been sponsored jointly by the four State General Service Committees since 1957 when the first statewide get-together was held in Columbus.

"In 1964, as in 1957, the conference grew from the minds of the four Delegates in mid-December (1963) meeting at which the format and the theme were developed in outline form, to be detailed by the Host Area Delegate for presentation to all state G.S.R.'s, Committee Members and officers at a final programming meeting late in January."

George said the basic philosophy in planning meetings was to change the pace of the programs "somewhat" from year to year "so that they do not become stereotyped. In keeping with the plan of conference rotation from Area to Area within the state, the conference co-chairman each year is the Delegate from the Area scheduled to host the meeting the following year."

Midge McFadden, a member of the General Service Staff, suggested a number of ways in which the story of General Services can fit effectively into Area conference programs.

"Service is not a separate part of A.A. that may be included or excluded," Midge said. "Service is the very heart of A.A." She reminded the Delegates that many of the functions of G.S.O. are still news to many members who attend Area meetings. "There is a wealth of experience that might better be shared than shunned and G.S.O. people are ready and willing to do whatever they can to help in an Area."

Midge developed the concept that presentations on the work of G.S.O. — including the role of the Trustees — should be developed in terms of *specific* tasks and how they are performed.

"In a carefully planned convention program, invited G.S.O. personnel can be scheduled to participate in regular panels or meetings, rather than in a special 'General Service' meeting," she suggested.

INTERNATIONALISTS OBSERVER'S REPORT

(Captain Jack Sloggett)

Over the years as A.A. grows, seamen find it easier to find contacts in foreign lands. Owen F. of the Half Way house in Honolulu welcomes all who pass there on their way from the Pacific Coast to the East. There are also active Groups in India now and a small Group in Singapore, which has entertained several of our members; also a sergeant in the British Army who has been a contact at Hong Kong. Bob H., on the African run, makes all the A.A. meetings from Durban south to Capetown.

During the year, Captain Jack said, he had answered between 150 and 200 personal letters from Internationalists. They tell of their experiences in foreign lands, helping Loners and carrying the message wherever they may go. When on vacation in

this country, they attend meeting after meeting for insurance against their next trip away from home.

Internationalists have no regular meeting, "hence no Group troubles or personality clashes." As they seldom see each other, "Round Robin" bulletins, edited by Midge of G.S.O., are issued regularly and truly are "meetings away from home."

Last year it was suggested the seamen set a certain time of day (1500 London Time, 10:00 New York Time) to say a little prayer for each other, their families at home and the Group. These prayers go out at the same time all over the world, regardless of where the person may be. During the year many favorable replies to this suggestion have been noted.

ATTRACTION RATHER THAN PROMOTION

One of the highlights of the 1964 Conference was the Friday evening presentation on the public information principles and practices followed by the Public Information Committee of the General Service Board.

Trustee Allan Bachman, committee chairman, established the keynote when he said:

"In the final reckoning A.A. will not be judged by the literature and other information material it issues, or by its adeptness in the use of professional public relations techniques. A.A. will be judged by its own attractive example, not only as recovered alcoholics but as human beings. If these examples are not good, any publicity is too much and dangerous."

Niles Peebles, in his report, stressed that the committee is not actively engaged in seeking publicity for A.A. "Our purpose is not to 'get space' but to help reach the alcoholic who still suffers," he said. "As to the worthiness of this aim, we can only recall how many of us first made contact with A.A. because of something we or a friend or relative read about Alcoholics Anonymous." Niles said the public information kits presently available from G.S.O. are being reviewed to make them more useful and said comments and suggestions would be appreciated from the Delegates.

Describes 'Gratitude Luncheon'

Janet Graves, another committee member, described the most recent (November) "Gratitude Luncheon" at which the Society, through the committee, attempted to express A.A.'s gratitude for the understanding and support shown by press, radio and television over the years. These luncheons are programmed annually during the Thanksgiving holiday period.

Janet also commented briefly on the large number of radio and television programs that have helped to portray A.A. realistically during the past year. She noted that none had used "the hard sell" to attract alcoholics to A.A. Discussing several programs developed with the assistance of G.S.O., she stressed that A.A. has not been promoted like a headache powder. "Rather, we have tried to follow our traditional policy by presenting typical stories, giving accurate information about the Fellowship and hoping that those who need help will be attracted. We want the cooperation of nonalcoholics in the communications field; we are grateful when it is given; but our deepest concern is still for the man or woman who fumbles at the dial with one hand while holding a glass in the other."

Dick Moulton, also a member of P.I.C. as well as being an expert in the field of statistical research, reported on the continuing attempt to obtain "reasonably accurate" membership totals for A.A.

Describing his analysis of 1962 census cards and a random sample comprising all Groups in five states, one Canadian province and eight overseas Areas, Dick said the resulting "projection factors" lead to a conservative estimate that A.A. membership exceeds 350,000 worldwide.

Additional approaches to the problem of estimating total membership are being studied, he said.

Reporting on A.A.'s exhibit materials for use at professional meetings, committeeman Fred Waters said that the large "senior" display in use for the past eight years was prepared specifically for national meetings or conventions in various professional fields.

New Display Prepared

To fill the need for a smaller display unit suitable for state and local meetings of professional groups, P.I.C. has developed a "junior" display. A copy of the new unit, "a standee, easeled, table-top display, light in weight and easily shipped in a pre-cut, cardboard wrap-around," was shown to the Delegates. The new unit has been designed as a "one-way" item; that is, it does not have to be shipped back to G.S.O. after being used. The "junior" has already been used effectively at several local and county meetings, Fred said.

Murray Whitsett, co-chairman of P.I.C. who will succeed Allan Bachman as chairman this year, said that the 30th Anniversary International Convention in Toronto will be utilized to encourage editorial recognition of A.A.'s purposes and achievements throughout the United States and Canada. "If we do not take leadership in such a program," Murray said, "others may seize on the anniversary for less accurate news accounts dealing with A.A.'s development."

Murray reviewed the public information activity that had taken place in connection with the 25th Anniversary convention in Long Beach, California, and said that it had been helpful in attracting many alcoholics who sought the help A.A. offered.

A typical active public information program in Canada was outlined by Cliff Morris, Western Ontario's Delegate.

Projects carried out recently in Ontario, Cliff said, included the following:

1. Cooperation with a school for police recruits
2. Participation in a seminar at Queens University, Kingston
3. Participation in a study course at McMaster University, Hamilton
4. Display of an A.A. exhibit at a five-day meeting of the Ontario Public Health Association
5. Arrangements for simultaneous, province-wide "Open to the Public Meetings" on A.A.
6. Participation on a Hamilton station's radio program

Royalty Agreement On Bill's Writings Approved

Of all the factors responsible for the growth of A.A. (and for the sobriety of hundreds of thousands of men and women around the world), probably none is more important than the movement's book literature. The three major texts — "Alcoholics Anonymous," "The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" and "A.A. Comes of Age" — along with the service manual on *The Twelve Concepts of Service* are likely to endure as keys to personal sobriety and Group survival. All four publications have one thing in common; they were written or edited by Bill W., surviving co-founder, and the copyrights to them were assigned by Bill to the movement. The movement was thus assured ownership of its basic publications, the income from which has also underwritten many of the Society's world services.

For his services to A.A. over a period of nearly 30 years, Bill has never received salary compensation from the movement. His only income has been from royalties on his writings and editorial work. Because the earlier royalty agreements made no provision for protecting Lois, Bill's wife, in the event of Bill's death, and did not provide for a transfer of royalties to relatives to whom Bill and Lois have obligations, the agreements have been reviewed by the General Service Board in recent years.

As a result, the Board in April, 1963, concluded a new agreement with Bill which was submitted to the 1964 Conference for review and approval. The new agreement, outlined in the report of the Conference Finance Committee, was approved unanimously by the Delegates.

STEPS TAKEN TO STRENGTHEN G.S.C. COMMITTEES

Committee work has always been a vital factor in A.A. services at all levels of activity. In the Conference itself, committees have played an increasingly important role. Whereas, in earlier Conferences, committees normally functioned only during the meetings themselves, present-day Conference committees often handle a variety of assignments between the ending of one Conference and the beginning of the next.

However, the Conference committee structure developed quite informally. It was not until this year's Conference, during the course of a workshop on "Composition, Function and Future of Conference Committees," that Delegates had an opportunity to analyze this structure and correct certain deficiencies.

Participants in the workshop were Herb Morse, General Service Manager; Joe Ward, Minnesota; Jane Kenny, Central New York, and Jim Masterson, Western Region Trustee.

The Delegates approved four specific proposals advanced by Jim in his talk.

1. Approved enlarging Conference committees from six to eight members.

2. Approved the election by each committee of a first-year Delegate as co-chairman, with automatic succession to the chairmanship during the Delegate's second year of service.

3. Specified that Conference committee members shall serve full two-year terms dating from their selection to the committee until the opening of the second following Conference. (For example, a first-year Delegate selected for a committee at the 1964 Conference will be considered an active member of that committee until the opening of the 1966 Conference, even though his successor as Area Delegate may have been chosen months before the 1966 Conference.)

4. Approved making retiring committee members ex-officio members of the Conference committee for a period of one year, exclusively for the purpose of making the ex-Delegates' committee experience available to the committees with which they had been affiliated. (Thus, second-year members of 1964 Conference Committees will be ex-officio for the year following the 1965 Conference.)

The Delegates also reaffirmed unanimously their support of the principles of selecting committees by drawing the names of Delegates by lot. Customarily, a Delegate may withdraw his name when it is selected for a particular committee, and it is returned to the hat for possible selection to another committee.

The need for improved communication between committee members during the period between Conferences was stressed by Joe Ward. Jim Masterson also pleaded for increased sharing of correspondence on committee matters. The difficulty of making multiple copies of letters and other documents was noted, however.

"Feed back" is needed in the working of Conference committees, Joe suggested. "When ideas and suggestions are not fully understood, we need to have them explained and restated until true communication is accomplished. But the originator of the suggestion cannot know that he has not been fully understood unless the one who receives the letter indicates his lack of understanding. This can best be done by asking questions. And these questions too should be written so that copies can be sent to all other members to help them clarify their thinking. And so, too, with the answers. If this is followed, each member will share in all the discussion concerning every subject and each decision can be truly said to reflect the wishes of the entire committee."

In her discussion of "Year Round Work of Conference Committees," Jane made the following suggestions:

1. Establish definite deadline dates during the year so that suggestions from committee members can be timed to reach the General Service Board prior to its quarterly meetings.

2. Committee members should be informed immediately of G.S.B. reactions to committee suggestions.

3. Schedule "between-Conference" meetings of committees with G.S.O. Staff Members in New York.

4. Inform future Conference committees of the wealth of suggestions already on file at G.S.O.

TORONTO CONVENTION PLANS ARE REVIEWED

A full evening was scheduled for a joint meeting of the Convention Committee, the Convention Advisory Committee, and representatives of the Convention Host Committee. Although the session was scheduled as a Committee meeting rather than a Conference session, a number of Delegates and Staff attended and participated in the general discussion. Decisions are covered on page 36 under "1965 International Convention Committee."

Bill W. reminded the meeting that A.A. members used to fear Conventions "as a necessity." The experience of the meetings in Cleveland, St. Louis and Long Beach has dissipated those fears, he said. "We now look upon these meetings as a concentrated joyous, unique form of communication for the language of the heart," he declared.

The following day on the Conference floor, Whit Hillmer, Chairman of the Convention Advisory Committee, was invited to report on his recent trip across Canada and into the Pacific Coast A.A. Areas of the U.S. He reported high enthusiasm in all sections visited. Cliff Morris, public relations member of the Advisory Committee, made a formal report to the Conference and indicated that Canadians are making every effort to stage the most successful international gathering in A.A. history. The Advance Registration program for Canadians only is under way and results are highly encouraging.

A dance at the Royal York Hotel on Thursday evening, July 1, will precede the official opening of the Convention which will conclude with a special show Sunday evening, July 4.

It was agreed that general registration for the Convention (for the U.S. and other countries, as well as Canada) will get under way February 1, 1965 with all applications for registration and rooms processed on a first-come, first-served basis.

After considerable discussion, the Conference expressed its interest in some kind of Al-Anon participation in the Convention program, the decision being left to the Convention Committee.

The Conference felt that ex-Delegates might participate in some way and the programming of such participation was to be determined by the Convention Committee. Delegates expressed themselves as favoring a Convention badge which carries the first name and last initial of the registrant, since that is the custom of Ontario A.A.

Electoral Procedures

Prior to the balloting to select a replacement Trustee for the East Central Region, Delegates were given an opportunity to comment on the question: "Are electoral procedures for Regional Trustees satisfactory?"

It quickly became obvious that all Delegates were satisfied with the present procedures. A resolution reaffirming endorsement of the procedures was adopted unanimously.

BOOK DISCOUNT WAIVER

The need for assuring continuity of A.A.'s world services has been a matter of concern for many years. The question has been: What would happen to G.S.O. services if, due to a general economic recession or to other unfortunate happenings, income from contributions and publishing was no longer adequate to cover expenses?

The problem of some kind of reserve received special attention after the General Service Conference came into being and various solutions were explored. Finally, in 1954 and 1955 the movement, through the Conference, set up a plan whereby the Groups would waive their rights to a portion of the discounts they had been receiving on purchases of A.A. books. Under the plan, the funds thus accumulated would be allocated to the Reserve Fund until the sum of \$300,000 had been built up.

Although the Reserve Fund does not yet total \$300,000, this figure may be reached within the next twelve months. The problem facing the Conference was whether to continue the present book discount program or to return full discounts to the Groups. If retained the "ceiling" might be raised to keep step with the current budget needs of a rapidly growing A.A. — or the money might be ear-marked for specific uses. Linked to the discussion was a strong sense of meeting that some kind of pension should be considered for G.S.O. workers. Discussion brought out the possibility that the present book discount waiver arrangement might possibly finance a pension plan.

Until such a program could be prepared and submitted to the next Conference, the 1964 Conference approved the report of the joint meeting of the General Service Board and the Conference Finance Committees that the present book discount waiver be continued, and that the possibility of a pension program be thoroughly explored and reported back to the next Conference.

Approve Trustee Nominees

The Conference approved the nominations of two A.A. members as Class B (alcoholic) Trustees of the General Service Board.

Murray Whitsett, a Director of A.A. World Services and co-chairman of the G.S.B. Public Information Committee, was nominated to succeed Allan Bachman as a Service Trustee. Murray has been a member of A.A. for 12 years and is currently active in the New Canaan, Connecticut Group. He is a newspaper advertising executive.

Bruce Mansfield of Akron, Ohio, was nominated to succeed Howard Bennhoff, also of Ohio, who died during his first year in office as a Class B Regional Trustee. Bruce has been a member of A.A. for 19 years and is currently an active member of the King School Group, Akron. He is president and a director of an Ohio Corporation. (Both nominees were elected to the Board at its meeting, April 27, 1964.)

Use Of Proxies

The use of proxies, whereby one G.S.R. who attends an A.A. Area Assembly is able to cast ballots for absent Representatives, has been discussed at a number of Conferences, generally with respect to representation of Groups in institutions.

The 1964 Conference was asked to express the movement's experience with, and attitude toward, this practice as a general procedure.

It was the sense of the meeting, reflected in a showing of hands after a brief discussion of the subject, that the proxy system of voting could lead to abuses and that few Areas were prepared to endorse the practice at this time, as far as general representation of regular Groups is concerned.

At the same time it was recognized that Groups in correctional institutions and in certain hospitals might be unrepresented at Area Assemblies if they were not permitted to assign their voting privileges to members outside their Groups.

AREA DELEGATES ONLY

As is traditional at Conferences, one evening session was devoted to a meeting exclusively for Area Delegates. All other Conference members were excluded.

Pertinent developments, reported from the 1964 "Area Delegates Only" session, included the following:

1. The meeting chairman was elected, rather than being selected by drawing a name by lot. Claude Millsap, Alaska (Panel #14) was elected.
2. Frank Surman, San Diego, California (Panel #14) was elected chairman of the Hospitality Committee. (Previously, the Southeastern New York Delegate had automatically been responsible for this service.) It was suggested that three members of the Committee be Delegates from Southeastern New York, New Jersey and Connecticut. Four additional Delegates volunteered to serve: Fred Watson, Rhode Island; Milton Hause, Maryland; Judy Machler, Montana and Doris Gurnsey, New Hampshire. Approved the plan started at this Conference to have as secretary for the Hospitality Committee a woman A.A. from Southeastern New York.
3. It was suggested that G.S.O. consider the possibility of devising badges that would permit immediate identification of new panel Delegates who arrive in New York prior to Conference registration day.
4. A suggestion that a "Sharing Session" involving G.S.O. Staff Members and Delegates be held was referred to the Agenda Committee.
5. It was suggested that G.S.O. re-institute the practice of having advance copies of talks available to Delegates at the time presentations are made, as was done at the 1963 Conference.
6. The meeting agreed that present Delegates should attend the 1965 Convention in Toronto "as A.A. members only."

Several subjects were discussed without formal conclusions being reached: (a) Use or misuse of the term "bleeding deacons," (b) The selection, composition and function of Conference Committees, (c) Three-year terms for Delegates, and (d) A.A. literature and outside agencies.

Identification For Literature

Further printings of all Conference-approved literature will carry, in addition to the A.A. seal, the wording: "This is A.A. General Service Conference-approved literature."

Also, literature about A.A. that is reprinted and distributed with Conference approval, will carry the following text: "This material has been reprinted with the approval of the A.A. General Service Conference."

Both of the above steps, recommended by the Literature Committees of the General Service Board and of the Conference, were approved unanimously by the 1964 Delegates.

Salary Patterns Approved

Recent national publicity on the salary paid to some G.S.O. employees provided an opportunity for a special report to the Delegates on salary policies and procedures at G.S.O., following which questions were invited from the floor.

After brief discussion, G.S.O. practices in this area were endorsed firmly by the Delegates. Their action was later confirmed in their unanimous adoption of the report of the Conference Policy Committee which stated that the latter "heartily approves the pattern of G.S.O. employee compensation."

NON-A.A. TRUSTEES' ROLE BEING STUDIED

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, which acts as the custodian of A.A.'s world services, traditionally comprises two "classes" of Trustees. Class A Trustees are nonalcoholic friends of the movement, distinguished in business or the professions, who serve one-year terms which may be renewed annually. Class B Trustees are A.A. members who may not serve more than four one-year terms, following which they are "rotated" off the Board.

Over the years there have been proposals, by A.A.'s and non-A.A.'s, that the term of Class A members be limited and that they, also, be "rotated" off the Board after a specified maximum number of years.

Bill W., surviving co-founder of the movement, has frequently reminded Conference Delegates of the great debt of gratitude A.A. owes to the nonalcoholics who have served on the Board,

pointing out that without their contributions, particularly in the early days of the Society, A. A. could not have achieved its present position.

Bill spoke briefly, stating his hope that the Board's report will point to some limitation of term for Class A Trustees, so that the principle of "rotation" may apply to both classes of Trustees.

Dr. John L. Norris, nonalcoholic chairman of the Board, told the Conference the matter is currently being studied by the Board and that a report will be made to the Delegates prior to the 1965 meeting of the Conference.

The question of "rotation" was on the agenda for discussion purposes only and no decision or "sense of the meeting" was sought from Delegates.

Monthly Sharing Plan

The 1963 General Service Conference had approved a plan for joint exploration with G.S.O. of the possibility of making General Services increasingly self-supporting by encouraging Groups to contribute on a regular monthly basis. Delegates were asked to discuss the proposal in their Areas, reporting their findings to G.S.O.

As a result of these Area reports, a joint meeting of the Finance Committees of the General Service Board and of the Conference was arranged in New York last fall. After careful consideration, it was agreed to test the "Monthly Sharing Plan" in certain Areas.

In a report to the 1964 Conference, G.S.O. was able to note that the Plan appeared to be working successfully in the test Areas, based on contributions received from the Areas during the first three months of the year.

Of the 769 Groups in the six test Areas, 267 contributed during the first quarter of 1964. Total contributions were 60 per cent higher than a year earlier. One-third of Groups in the test Areas participated in the Plan, compared with 20 per cent of Groups who had made contributions to G.S.O. during the first quarter of 1963.

While no definite action was taken to extend the test to other Areas, there were indications that a number of Areas may volunteer to adopt the "Monthly Sharing Plan" during the coming year.

Test New Mailing Plan

As A.A. grows, communications problems involving G.S.O. and the Groups multiply in complexity and cost. The rapidly increasing activity of G.S.R.'s and Area Committees compound these problems. At present, the Conference was told, there are approximately 20,000 names of Group secretaries, G.S.R.'s, and others on the G.S.O. mailing list.

Traditionally, both the Group secretary and the G.S.R. have received G.S.O. mailings. This custom developed at a time when the G.S.R. function was new and when some G.S.R.'s were less than zealous in passing information from G.S.O. along to their Group membership. Today, however, it may be that duplicate mailings to Groups are no longer necessary in many Areas. If this is so, substantial amounts of money can be saved through elimination of unnecessary duplication of communications.

After considering the problem carefully, the 1964 Conference approved a proposal to send G.S.O. correspondence exclusively to the G.S.R.'s in certain volunteer test Areas. Results of the experiment will be evaluated after an appropriate period to determine whether this plan should be extended more widely.

New Provincial Delegate

A recurring dilemma confronting Delegates since the founding of the Conference in 1950 has been how to determine when a new Area should be created. Various criteria of geography, A.A. population and language requirements have been applied, with generally satisfactory results. In a number of cases, admissions that have been denied when applications were first made have been granted in following years.

Three applications for additional Delegates were presented to the 1964 Conference: from the State of Indiana, from Northwestern Ontario, Canada and from the Atlantic Provinces of Canada.

Several Factors Analyzed

The application from the Atlantic Provinces was granted, based on analysis of the territory to be covered, present problems of communications and the accelerating growth of the A.A. population.

The two other applications were tabled and may, of course, be made again at the 1965 Conference. In the case of Indiana, it was suggested that "more use be made of the State Committee and of larger A.A. gatherings."

In the case of Northwestern Ontario, the Admissions Committee was sympathetic in view of the large territory (1,800 square miles) to be covered, but felt that "additional growth" would be desirable before the application is granted.

'Latin American' Workshop

During the past year the General Service Board has given additional recognition to the accelerating growth of A.A. around the world through creation of an International Committee. The purpose of the Committee is to "evaluate the A.A. picture overseas and determine what steps G.S.O. should and could take to stimulate the growth of A.A. along orderly lines" outside the U. S. and Canada. An area of special interest has been Central and South America where A.A. has grown rapidly in recent years.

To assist Groups and members in Latin America, the International Committee proposed a plan to sponsor a workshop at G.S.O. for locally elected representatives from six countries: El Salvador, Honduras, Costa Rica, Guatemala, Mexico and Colombia. A.A.'s in each country would contribute \$100 of their representatives' transportation costs. A representative from Puerto Rico would also be invited. The estimated cost of the project to G.S.O. is \$3,000. The workshop would concentrate on problems of A.A.'s structure and service responsibilities.

Following presentation of the proposal by Trustee Allan Bachman, International Committee chairman, the 1964 Conference approved the proposed workshop.

DEMONSTRATION 'SHARING SESSION'

"How can our Group work with professional people helping the alcoholic — doctors, clergymen, law enforcement officials and social workers?"

This was the topic of a lively demonstration "Sharing Session" staged during the 1964 Conference. Following is a brief outline of answers recorded:

1. "When this help is given you must remember that it is not always possible to maintain personal anonymity. Hold open meetings with a program of speakers including doctors, clergymen, etc."
2. "Get your A.A. viewpoint across."
3. "Important to follow up after these contacts are made and you have received their help."
4. "Contact should be made on a personal level. Win their confidence. Get them to attend A.A. meetings to get a better idea of how A.A. works."
5. "Sometimes chain reaction will occur by contacting one professional person. He in turn may contact another."
6. "Contact on individual basis. Hold open meetings to invite these people."
7. "Advantage of having 85% of meetings held in churches. Set up a seminar. This was very successful in my Area and led to a series of these meetings. Use a family service agency."
8. "Groups should make it known that their members are available to be of assistance."
9. "Invite these people to public meetings. Don't ask them all at the same time, but have separate meetings for doc-

tors, clergymen, etc. Express to them how important they are."

10. "Use the available pamphlets to familiarize them with the Steps and Traditions. Establish good relationship with the courts."
11. "Give a specific problem to these people to settle. 'We will help you,' not 'This is what we need.'"
12. "Set up a special committee to answer all requests for information."
13. "Hold meetings at state universities."
14. "Refer requests to the P.I.C. in state."
15. "Visit state hospitals. Sometimes the meetings they hold are not A.A., but they are a basis for the patient to contact A.A. after release."
16. "Invite them to be on panels on this subject. We have helped drunks from the courts by giving them a probation period in A.A."
17. "Have individual members bring their family doctor."
18. "Don't force the program."
19. "Problem should not be handled at Group level. Should be left to the P.I.C. in the state; that is what they are there for."
20. "Cooperate with Sheriff's office. Can get prisoner out for A.A. meetings."
21. "Use pamphlets addressed to professional people."
22. "Invite general public to open meeting."
23. "Speak before a public school."

'TABLE TOPIC' SESSIONS

"Table Topic" sessions on Sponsorship and on ways in which past Delegates can be of special service were highlights of the 1964 Conference.

Following are some of the responses, in abbreviated form, to the question: "How can a Group give new A.A.'s better sponsorship?"

1. "New A.A. member should get his own sponsor."
2. "Show more interest and concern for newcomer."
3. "Give whole subject of sponsorship more attention, give new person something to do."
4. "Have interview session with newcomer, done on card system, then can pick Sponsor best suited for newcomer."
5. "Have Group sponsorship service committee to welcome newcomer, stay with him for about four to six weeks, then let him pick own sponsor."
6. "Extend hand of welcome and friendship."
7. "Hold beginners' meetings before regular Group meeting to acquaint newcomer with Group functions, give him better understanding of Group and work of A.A."
8. "Educate new person on whole A.A. program."
9. "Make person feel as though he is the most important thing at the meeting."
10. "Have welcoming committee to help him to know more people."
11. "Have Sponsorship committee and then let newcomer pick his own sponsor."
12. "Impress upon newcomer need for sponsorship, give gift 'Grapevine' subscription."

13. "Let newcomer choose three prospective sponsors, and after period of time, select one."

And here are some of the answers to the topic: "Which job in your Area do you find a past Delegate does best?"

1. "Whatever he is asked."
2. "Area Assembly work and continuity of Area service."
3. "State convention work and working with outside agencies."
4. "Speaking at round-ups, general service operations."
5. "Ex-officio for all committees, available for counsel."
6. "Available to discuss G.S.O.; member of State Committee for next two years as adviser."
7. "Participate in Area Assemblies in ex-officio capacity and keep active."
8. "Keep own active membership as an A.A."
9. "Adviser with State Committee without vote."
10. "Carrying message of world services and safe-guarding structure and service function."
11. "Serve as permanent member of State or Area Committees, become state chairman for two years, Grapevine Representative, finance chairman and P.I.C. member."
12. "Adviser at all levels."
13. "Adviser to all new Delegates for help in all matters."

GRAPEVINE INVENTORY

The Grapevine's Directors, Editorial Board, Development Committee and Staff are committed to the established A.A. principle of taking continuing inventory. Mary Bernson, Chairman of the Board of A.A.'s international journal, reminded the Delegates.

Mary's comments were part of a full-scale presentation by the seven members of the Grapevine's corporate board. Highlights follow:

On the Staff

"Originally the Grapevine Staff was all volunteer. At about the same time that the magazine was incorporated as a part of A.A. (1946), it became necessary to add paid employees to handle mailings . . . As time went on, it proved advisable to have one or more permanent paid A.A. Staff Members. The editor, chief executive officer of the Grapevine, has usually been, and is now, a volunteer. He has a staff of four: a part-time editorial assistant, two full-time associate editors and a part-time art director. . . Six paid nonalcoholic employees perform secretarial, bookkeeping, mailing and other functions. Of the total of ten editorial and office employees, four are A.A. members . . ."

The Directors determine policy and delegate authority for day-to-day operations to the editor who, in turn, relies on his assistants to work effectively with the large number of A.A. volunteers and with the printers. All articles are contributed free.

On Finances

The Grapevine was not set up to be a profit-making enterprise. No capital was ever put up. From the beginning, subscription receipts were used to pay current bills. Debts were incurred as the magazine grew and funds totaling \$13,660 were advanced by the General Service Board to cover the deficits. Full repayment of these advances was made in December, 1963. There was a substantial operating surplus for the year.

On Editorial Policy

The editors of the Grapevine have all viewed the magazine as a journal or forum for the presentation of individual A.A. opinion and experience and the counsel of nonalcoholic friends. It has been called "a meeting in print," or, in Bill's words, "a sort of magic carpet on which all of us can travel from one distant A.A. outpost to another."

On Circulation Policy

The large part of the Grapevine's circulation over the years has come about by word-of-mouth advertising. Today, about 58 per cent of the total circulation is purchased by Groups; about 42 per cent is in the form of individual subscription. Circulation in January was 41,116. Respecting Tradition Eleven ("attraction rather than promotion"), the magazine's Development Committee has recommended against direct mail letters, special price offers, premiums and the like and has stated a belief that the magazine itself is the best tool to use in accomplishing circulation objectives.

Special Edition Approved

Requests for special editions of A.A. books are not unusual at General Service Conferences. The 1964 Conference was no exception. It became evident early in the meeting that there was substantial movement demand for an edition of "The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" that would be smaller in size and generally more compact than the existing edition. The proposed edition would presumably be used primarily for gifts and would be particularly useful to members who travel.

An important factor in all proposals for new editions of A.A. books is whether or not a new edition will affect the acceptance of a book in its present format. Paperback reprints of A.A. books, for example, would unquestionably result in decreased demand for hard cover editions. The resulting loss in income would affect both G.S.O. and the G oups.

Digest Of Agenda

April 21-26, 1964 Hotel Roosevelt, New York
Theme—"PRACTICING THESE PRINCIPLES"

Tuesday, April 21

Registration and Tour of G.S.O.
Welcome Session and Introduction of General Service Staff
Opening Dinner: Greetings by Lois and Bill
Regular A.A. Meeting

Wednesday, April 22

Workshop: "Composition, Function and Future of Conference Committees"
Selection of Conference Committees and Committee Meetings
Reports of General Service Board Committees
Presentation of New G.S.O. Filmstrip
Report on 1965 International Convention at Toronto

Thursday, April 23

"The Grapevine Takes Its Inventory"
Discussions: Class A Trustees; Group Mailings; Study Guides; Gift Editions; Trustee Electoral Procedures.
Nomination of Replacement for East Central Region Trustee
Reports from Overseas Observers and Internationalists Observer
Area Delegates Only Meeting

Friday, April 24

Preliminary Conference Committee Reports; Discussion
"The Conference Takes Its Inventory"
"Table Topics" Presentations on Sponsorship, Institutions and Past Delegates
Discussions: Proxies, Membership Figures
Public Information Committee Presentation
Screening of kinescope of Television Program: "Wisdom to Know the Difference."

Saturday, April 25

Presentation: "Area, State and Regional Conferences"
Final Reports from Conference Committees
Discussions: Name for General Service; Length of Conference
Demonstration "Sharing Sessions"

Sunday, April 26

Final Conference Brunch
Talks by Ruby Black, Area Delegates' Chairman; Dr. Jack Norris, General Service Board Chairman; Roy Scovil, Area Trustee; Allan Bachman, General Service Trustee and Bill W., Co-founder.
Visit to Lois' and Bill's home, "Stepping Stones."

Throughout the Conference, time was set aside for brief presentations ("Area Highlights") by Panel 14 Delegates. More than 40 Delegates reported on specific phases of A.A. development in their Areas.

In addition, there were a number of "Ask-It Basket" sessions during which questions submitted anonymously from the floor were discussed and answered.

A.A. World Services, Inc./G.S.O.

(Herb Morse, Chairman)

No such problem was involved in the 1964 proposal since it was agreed that the new, limited edition should be priced to sell for \$3.00 or more.

After full consideration of all factors, the 1964 Conference authorized G.S.O. and its publishing agency, A.A. World Services, Inc., to prepare the new edition of "The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions." It was further specified that the new edition should be introduced at the 30th Anniversary International Convention in Toronto, Canada in July, 1965.

A.A. World Services, Inc., is the operating entity for most G.S.O. activities. It is responsible for General Services and for the publishing and distribution of Conference-approved books and pamphlets.

Included in G.S.O.'s administrative staff are the Manager of General Services; the Coordinator of Staff and the other five Staff Members; Supervisor of Accounting; Supervisor of Clerical/Steno; Supervisor of Records; Supervisor of Shipping; and the Archivist. There is a total of 38 full-time and four part-time employees at G.S.O.

PUBLISHING: Distribution of A.A. literature continues to increase. In 1963, sales of books and pamphlets ran 3.2% ahead of the previous year, and contributed \$39,400 toward overhead and the operation of other General Services.

In 1963, A.A.W.S. authorized free distribution of 174,230 pieces of literature with an actual cost of \$7,210 plus shipping costs. It also authorized the pricing of foreign language literature to meet the needs of low economy countries — particularly in Latin America.

Distribution of all books, pamphlets, miscellaneous items and tapes of A.A. talks in 1963 totaled more than 1,300,000 units.

SHIPPING: The year 1963 was one of expansion for Shipping. Al Cryan supervises six full-time and three part-time employees to keep ahead of the schedule. Last year the department handled 70,963 incoming mail items (inquiries, Group letters, contributions, orders) and sent out 242,600 mail items (including Bulletin mailings). Book and pamphlet orders accounted for 37,687 packages shipped.

CLERICAL/STENO: This year this department has increased from 10 to 13. Kleina Jones, Supervisor, has added another translator to handle our non-English-speaking correspondence, mainly French and Spanish. Due to the increasing amount of letters received and sent, two people are now working in the file unit. Over a thousand visitors signed our guest book this year, and were escorted through the office by our receptionist-guide.

ACCOUNTING: This department, staffed by three full-time (and one part-time) employees under the supervision of Dennis Manders, processed 11,700 orders and acknowledged and recorded 11,500 contributions during the past year. There were also payrolls to be prepared, bills to be processed and paid, the general books to be kept, statistics to be maintained and periodic analyses to be made of literature costs, payroll comparisons, etc.

RECORDS: This department has completed its first full year under the direction of Marie Proctor. It is manned by a staff of four, one of whom is a varitype operator. The department received all correspondence involving change of Group address and officers, worked with the Steno Department and Staff Members to make and acknowledge changes. It prepared all directories — the "World Directory," directories of Groups in institutions, and special lists.

ARCHIVES: Nell Wing, Bill's secretary, is also in charge of the A.A. archives. This library, maintained since A.A.'s

SHIPPED DURING 1963

BOOKS

Alcoholics Anonymous	32,105
Twelve Steps & Twelve Traditions	11,155
Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age	3,684
Alcoholics Anonymous — Spanish	1,366

PAMPHLETS

This is A.A.	120,086
44 Questions & Answers	105,958
Is A.A. For You?	124,556
Partners in A.A.	28,368
Young People in A.A.	43,394
A.A. For The Woman	45,100
Memo To An Inmate	23,442
A.A. Tradition — How It Developed	20,011
Questions & Answers on Sponsorship	30,860
Alcoholism the Illness	56,613
The Alcoholic Husband	61,264
The Alcoholic Wife	42,523
A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee	26,668
A.A. & The Medical Profession	30,510
Tranquilizers, Sedatives & the Alcoholic	50,002
A.A. — Helpful Ally in Coping with Alcoholism	60,127
Saturday Evening Post Reprint	38,930
Fortune Reprint	27,533
Good Housekeeping Reprint	34,594
The Third Legacy Manual	4,794
Twelve Concepts	5,209
Inside A.A.	24,888
The Fellowship of A.A.	54,090
A Clergyman Asks About A.A.	33,811
G.S.R. Folder	17,606
Foreign Translations	54,235
Total Pamphlets Shipped	1,165,172

MISCELLANEOUS

Wallet Cards	234,903
Parchment Scrolls	1,714
How It Works (Excerpt from Big Book)	37,210

SOUND TAPES

Eight Tapes carrying talks by A.A.'s or about A.A.	1,350
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early days, consists of a great variety of historical material, including the Group history files, books and pamphlets (all editions), Conference Reports, directories, scrapbooks, photographs, film prints, tapes and early records of the movement.

Group Services

(Beth Kuhlmann)

The General Service Office today serves 10,956 Groups throughout the world. In 1963, 886 new Groups were registered — 652 in the United States and Canada, 206 overseas, 38 in hospitals and 80 in prisons.

Each new Group listed received a welcoming letter, free literature samples, a copy of the "A.A. Exchange Bulletin" and a "World Directory." All Groups received the "Exchange Bulletin" regularly and a copy of the "World Directory."

The newsletter "Central Office and Intergroup Exchange" is sent out to 182 Intergroups and Central Offices quarterly.

As a new service, a list of Indian Groups was prepared and sent to 32 Groups.

Armed Forces Groups are still being formed throughout the world and there is special material available to answer requests for information on specialized problems that may arise in these Groups. A list of all Armed Forces Groups is maintained and distributed.

G.S.B. Public Information Committee

(Allan Bachman, Chairman)

The Public Information Committee was formed in 1956 to fill a need, expressed by Bill, for a broader sharing of responsibility in sustaining A.A.'s sound movement-wide public relations. A regular standing committee of the Board of Trustees, P.I.C.'s actions are subject to approval by the Board and by the Policy Committee. P.I.C. is also bound to adhere to A.A. Traditions in all public relations activities and to the policy statement, "Responsibilities of the Movement for Keeping People Informed," approved by the 1961 Conference. For the past five years, P.I.C. has functioned as a working group, meeting monthly.

P.I.C. cooperates with all public information media and outside agencies to improve public understanding and to prevent misunderstanding of the A.A. program and Fellowship. It also supplies information and special materials to assist local Groups and Areas in their public information activities.

Cooperation with Media

P.I.C. released two important statements to media during the past year: The first release announced the election of Judge John M. Murtagh and Dr. W. Harvey Cruickshank as nonalcoholic members of the General Service Board.

The second statement, released on September 10, 1963, constituted A.A.'s third annual "Report to the General Public," a summary of the highlights of the 1963 Conference Report. Prior to the mailing, it was also sent to Delegates for appropriate local use. The release received excellent coverage throughout the United States and Canada. The Board of Trustees has now given P.I.C. permission to issue the report to the public immediately after this Conference.

On November 14, the Board of Trustees sponsored another "Gratitude Luncheon" for media people who have made a special contribution to A.A. during the recent past. Bill spoke, expressing the movement's gratitude for their support and encouragement of the A.A. program. Hosted by members of P.I.C., the luncheon was another important contribution toward strengthening A.A.'s relations with media.

With due regard for personal anonymity, P.I.C. members participated in a televised closed A.A. meeting which was shown on station WABC-TV (New York, N.Y.) on November 17, under the title "The Wisdom to Know the Difference." Many favorable comments were received, both from A.A. members and nonalcoholics, and the program may be rerun nationally.

Members of P.I.C. have also reviewed and commented on the scripts of a number of television programs and on manuscripts making reference to A.A.

Cooperation with Outside Agencies

Last year, the Chairman of P.I.C. spoke on "How A.A. Cooperates with Other Agencies" at the national conference of the National Council on Alcoholism and on the same subject at the Alcoholism Studies Summer School, Rutgers University. The Secretary of the Committee talked at the Midwest Institute on Alcohol Studies and at the Annual Conference of the Boston Committee on Alcoholism. She also represented the Committee at N.A.A.A.P.'s annual meeting.

The Chairman and Co-Chairman of the Committee participated in a meeting of A.A. clergymen in North Conway, N. H., and the G.S.O. General Manager attended a meeting on alcoholism held by the Department of Health, Education and Welfare in Washington, D. C.

At these meetings, P.I.C. members were able to explain our traditional policy of "Cooperation But Not Affiliation" to the professional people in attendance.

In February, P.I.C. members and the G.S.O. Staff met in New York with the executive Committee of N.A.A.A.P. Further progress was made in strengthening relations between A.A. and the official agencies in certain areas. A high degree of friendly understanding of our respective positions now exists.

P.I.C. met with representatives of N.C.A. and N.A.A.A.P. regarding the publication statements by each organization defining their roles in the alcoholism field. Each organization had prepared its statement separately, supplied copies to the other organizations for their use in answering inquiries. The

A.A.'s POSITION IN THE FIELD OF ALCOHOLISM

Alcoholics Anonymous is a worldwide fellowship of recovered alcoholics who help each other maintain sobriety and who offer to share their recovery experience freely with other men and women who may have a drinking problem. A.A. members are distinctive in their acceptance of all or part of a program of Twelve Suggested Steps designed for personal recovery from alcoholism.

The Fellowship functions through approximately 11,000 local Groups in 80 countries. Several hundred thousand alcoholics have achieved sobriety in A.A., but members recognize that their program is not always effective with all alcoholics and that some may require professional counseling or treatment.

A.A. is concerned solely with the personal recovery and continued sobriety of individual alcoholics who turn to the Fellowship for help. The movement does not engage in the fields of alcoholism research, medical or psychiatric treatment, education or propaganda in any form although members may participate in such activities *as individuals*.

The movement has adopted a policy of "cooperation but not affiliation" with other organizations concerned with the problem of alcoholism.

Traditionally, Alcoholics Anonymous does not accept or seek financial support from outside sources and members preserve personal anonymity in print and broadcast media and otherwise at the public level.

statement about A.A. as approved by P.I.C. and the Board of Trustees and now submitted to the Conference appears above.

P.I.C. also approved production of a one-way table-top display regarding A.A. for local and state professional meetings. Many requests have been received from such meetings in the past. Use of the Professional Exhibit is limited to large national or regional meetings.

Statistics

The Board of Trustees asked P.I.C. to determine a better way of handling A.A. statistics. An investigation by qualified professional sources revealed that we have sufficient statistical information to substantiate a claim of total membership between 350,000 and 400,000. P.I.C. recommended (with Board approval) that in the future, in all references to A.A.'s membership, it be stated that there are more than 11,000 A.A. Groups and an estimated total membership of more than 350,000.

P.I.C. also investigated the claim that 50% of chronic alcoholics who seek help voluntarily through the Fellowship attain stable sobriety immediately, while another 25% arrest their compulsive drinking after a period of further experimentation. P.I.C. was unable to find evidence to support this claim today and, with the approval of the Board of Trustees, recommended that it be abandoned. Investigation will continue to determine whether evidence can be found to support other figures accurately representative of the "success ratio" of the program.

The 30th Anniversary

P.I.C. intends to utilize the 30th Anniversary year as an opportunity for encouraging editorial recognition of A.A. in the U.S. and Canada and throughout the world. If we fail to take leadership in such a program, the anniversary may be used by others as a basis for less accurate news accounts dealing with A.A.'s development. In this connection, P.I.C. plans to cooperate closely with P.I.C. representatives in Canada and is already so engaged.

Literature Committee

(Ivan Underwood, Chairman)

Significant activities of the Literature Committee during the past year included the following:

In accordance with the recommendation of the joint meeting of the Conference and Board Literature Committees of the 1963 Conference, the pamphlet, "Correctional Officials Evaluate A.A.," was discontinued and a new pamphlet, "A.A. in Prisons," was created. The new pamphlet will soon be available.

Also, in accordance with the suggestion of the Literature Committee of the 1963 Conference, the pamphlet, "Tranquilizers, Sedatives and the Alcoholic," was revised. The revised pamphlet will be available for distribution in the near future. The Committee offers a special note of thanks to Allan B., who drafted the pamphlet, to a subcommittee of the Board appointed by Dr. Norris to review the subject, and to three members of the International Doctors of A.A. who were particularly helpful in preparing the material in the pamphlet.

The present "Partners" pamphlet is being revised and retitled "The Group Handbook" with the subtitle, "How the A.A. Group Starts and Grows." Following review by both the Literature Committee of the Board and the Literature Committee of the Conference, this pamphlet will be available for distribution.

A request of the 1963 Conference Literature Committee was noted for a review of the need for a study guide for the Twelve Steps. After discussion, it was the feeling of the Committee that the book "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" in itself constitutes a study guide. It was further suggested that the 1964 Conference Agenda include discussion as to study meetings and other types of meetings directed particularly at the newcomer.

The "Third Legacy Manual" and the "Twelve Concepts of World Service" are now combined in a single edition.

The Committee recommended to the General Service Board and the 1964 General Service Conference that approval be given:

- (a) To carry the words "This is an A.A. Conference-approved pamphlet" under the seal on all Conference-approved literature and,
- (b) To carry on reprints the seal and the wording: "This material has been reprinted with the approval of the A.A. General Service Conference."

G.S.B. POLICY COMMITTEE

(Tom Sharpe, Chairman)

The G.S.B. Policy Committee was appointed and authorized to deal with problems of external policy of the General Service Board of A.A. and on policy matters affecting A.A. as a whole. It makes recommendations and prepares a report for each meeting of the General Service Board.

There are ten voting members of the committee. But all Trustees, A.A. World Service Directors, Grapevine Directors, G.S.O. and Grapevine Staffs and members of the Public Information Committee are invited to attend. They are encouraged to participate in all discussions.

During the past year, the aims and functions of this committee were reviewed and new procedures were set up for dealing with the type of problems brought to the committee - and the methods of reporting recommendations and referrals to Trustees' meetings.

More than 35 items of business were referred to the General Service Board for its consideration and action.

A.A. Groups in Institutions

(Waneta New)

Latest tabulations provide the following box score on A.A. in institutions:

644 Groups in Prisons
514 Groups in Hospitals
72 Institutional Committees
610 Hospital and Prison Sponsors
143 Prison and Hospital A.A. Publications

A questionnaire was sent to all A.A. Groups in prisons and hospitals in February of this year as part of an over-all survey to determine if and how G.S.O. service to Groups in institutions can be improved.

The last survey was reported to the General Service Conference in 1958. Today, five years later, the needs are practically the same: more participation by Groups and members in the surrounding areas, and especially the need for more literature to circulate to the inmate member.

Highlights from the new study:

1. New members are brought to the Group by their own request, and there are very few requirements for admission other than the desire to do something about their drinking problem.
2. All types of meetings are held, chaired for the most part by inmate members, with outside members in attendance. The attendance of prison officials at meetings is diminishing.
3. A surprising number of Groups are not affiliated with an Institutional Committee.
4. A great many arrangements are being made for A. A. sponsorship after release.
5. A majority of Groups handle their meetings in much the same manner as Groups outside institutions.

Letters from individual prison and hospital sponsors, accompanying the completed questionnaire, pleaded for help in interesting other A.A. members in this A.A. work.

30th Anniversary International Convention of A.A.

July 1-3, 1965

Toronto

Canada

English-Speaking A.A. Overseas

(Midge McFadden)

A.A. has been growing steadily outside the U.S. and Canada. In order to provide better service for these overseas areas it was decided last September to make two service assignments: one Staff Member to handle the English-speaking areas — and one the non-English. A.A. is established in almost all the English-speaking countries of the world. It took hold and grew largely because suitable literature was available. A.A. started in Australia as early as 1944, in Ireland in 1946, in South Africa in 1947, and in England in 1947.

The General Service Board of Great Britain and Ireland publishes A.A. literature for the sterling areas. Last winter their warehouse burned and their stock of Big Books was lost. These books were the "old edition" and the Board requested permission of A.A.W.S. to reprint the New Edition. This permission was granted and the new books are now being published.

Personal anonymity is strictly observed in England, but nevertheless an A.A. meeting was televised there recently. The members being interviewed were shown from the back and it proved very effective.

Scotland has established an Area Central Office in Glasgow with a Board of Trustees. This is a seven-member board with four non-A.A.'s and three A.A.'s. They recently held a large public meeting there which was well attended by doctors, clergymen and other professional people.

New Zealand held its first Convention in February of 1964. They are building up Area Assemblies and slowly working out a service structure.

The Australian Service Conference had two important subjects on the agenda for its annual meeting at Easter. One concerns the appointment of Trustees and the other the formation of a Publishing Company. These look like giant steps along the road of service.

South Africa has an active General Service Office in Pretoria. At present there are 160 Groups and new ones being registered every week. The General Service Office publishes a "Newsletter" and "Group Directory" as a service to the Groups. They have an annual Conference at Easter each year which is attended by delegates from the Groups and the General Service Committee.

Some A.A. material is being translated into Zulu and printed by a group of members in Natal.

Because all our contact with the various Committees in these countries is by mail, there seems to be a need to standardize terms. For instance: a "General Service Board" in one place may be what we would call a "Steering Committee"; and "area assembly" sounds more like a public meeting — consequently these ambiguous terms contribute to misunderstanding. The "Third Legacy Manual" seems too complicated for developing Areas, and we are considering the need to simplify it to some extent for their use.

Non-English-Speaking A.A. Overseas

(Hazel Rice)

Language is virtually the only barrier to the growth of A.A. in overseas countries where English is not spoken. To overcome this barrier, and to disprove the theory that A.A. will not work in certain cultures, G.S.O. uses two main tools:

1. *Translation Service:* two full-time translators handling correspondence in Spanish, French and Italian; an "outside" service handles, German, Flemish and other languages.
2. *Translations of A.A. Literature:* A.A. literature is now available in Spanish, French, German, Norwegian, Finnish, Afrikaans, Swedish, Portuguese, Italian, Flemish and (to a limited extent) in Polish, Hungarian, Bantu and Isixhosa.

Europe

Germany, through assistance from Armed Forces Groups and active German A.A.'s, now has 50 Groups with 600 members. They have their own monthly bulletin published by and for German-speaking A.A.'s. Also, their own Literature Distribution Center at Karlsruhe, to which \$1,000 worth of German literature has been shipped on an extended credit basis.

Swiss A.A.'s have been busy in their three languages: French, German and Italian. Thirteen active Groups will sponsor their Second All-Swiss Get-Together in May of this year. Belgium has two service centers: one in Brussels (French) and the other in Antwerp (Flemish). Brussels A.A.'s had a successful public meeting marking their Tenth Anniversary. Antwerp members are busy translating; have just finished the text of the Big Book and working on Steps and Traditions. A.A. in Holland, France and Scandinavia is growing and active.

Spain and the Canary Islands are very busy carrying the message. Their growth from 14 to 18 Groups which has come about in the past year, reflects some of their activity. The A.A. Group in Las Palmas, Canary Islands has now a weekly radio program and newspaper coverage. Three years ago when Bill visited Las Palmas, there was no A.A. On March 7 of this year, more than 100 attended the First Spanish Convention held there.

Central America, South America & Mexico

In 1955 there was one A.A. in Central America; today there are more than 7,000 and 3,000 at public meetings is not unusual. Their Second Annual Convention will be held in Guatemala in May.

Mexico has grown more slowly but seems ready to burst forth.

In South America, Colombia has led in growth. They have some 70 of the 104 Groups in South America. Peru, Brazil and Chile indicate they, too, will soon be ready to grow.

General Service Conference

(Eve Marsh)

This past year has been a year of increased activity on all counts within the framework of the Conference and Conference activities.

Perhaps the most dramatic example is the increase in the number of G.S.R.'s on our mailing list. In March of 1963 we had listed 1,881 G.S.R.'s, in addition to the regular Group mailing. In February, 1964, there are 2,772 G.S.R.'s on this special list — an increase of 900. Perhaps as a result of this, 17,606 copies of the G.S.R. pamphlet have been distributed this year.

While the Committee mailing list continues at about the same number as last year, presently 1,145, reports from all Committees generally indicate more activity, with more meetings scheduled, and better participation.

Perhaps one of the ways in which Committees have been sparked has been through the use of the "Sharing Sessions." We have had many reports of their usefulness. Even in Areas where Committees were a little hesitant about utilizing them, some Delegates have instituted the idea, without calling it by the same name.

Another aspect of increased activity has been the tremendous contribution made to the Conference this year by Conference Committees. The Agenda Committee has been extremely active throughout the year, and a good share of the present Agenda is a direct result of its activities and recommendations. The Literature Committee has been most cooperative in responding to requests for review of various new pamphlets. The Budget & Finance Committee came in in the fall for joint sessions with the Trustees' Finance Committee.

International Committee

(Allan Bachman, Chairman)

The International Committee, a new committee established by the General Service Board as a subcommittee of the Policy Committee, was formed to evaluate the A.A. picture overseas and determine what steps the General Service Office should and could take to stimulate the growth of A.A. along orderly lines in foreign countries.

A.A. appears to be making satisfactory progress in English-speaking countries outside North America. However, in some of them, the Groups have not taken the initiative in forming Intergroups, Area Service Committees, or General Service Boards. It was agreed that one way to encourage A.A. growth and eliminate confusing terminology would be through publication and distribution of a revised edition of "How A.A. Starts and Grows." Work along these lines is in process.

A.A. appears to be making great progress in France, Germany and several of the Spanish-speaking countries, where translations of A.A. literature are generally available. However, A.A. appears to have made little or no progress in other countries, such as Italy, where there have been no or very few translations. The committee believes that G.S.O. should make basic A.A. literature available in countries where a need is indicated and A.A. is new.

The following items would be appropriate:

1. "This is A.A." (Also included in "This is A.A." should be the questions and the scoring from the pamphlet "Is A.A. For You?")
2. "The Twelve Steps" from the Book
3. "How A.A. Starts and Grows"
4. "The Twelve Traditions" from the Book
5. Background "Fellowship" pamphlet
6. At the time that these pamphlets are being prepared, the A.A.'s should be encouraged to translate the text of the Big Book. It will then be made available to them in the manner which seems most practical. Either it will then be made available to them in the manner which seems most practical. Either it will be published by A.A.W.S., Inc. or by the country involved, depending on which seems most expedient at the time.

On an experimental basis, the committee has had the first five of the above publications translated into Italian.

During the past few years, there has been a very rapid growth in the number of A.A. Groups and members in Central America and South America. However, in most of these places, there has been little or no effort on the part of the Groups to establish offices for meeting their service needs.

The committee considered several possible ways of assisting these countries to establish effective over-all service centers of their own. The best plan seemed to be to invite representatives from those Spanish-speaking countries in which A.A. has grown most rapidly to come to New York for orientation workshops intended to familiarize them with all phases of G.S.O. services. Specifically, we propose to ask El Salvador, Honduras, Costa Rica, Guatemala, Mexico and Colombia to elect representatives to come to New York for a six- or seven-day workshop which may be held next fall. Each of the countries would be asked to pay the first \$100 of trans-

portation costs and G.S.O. would assume the balance of the expenses, estimated to approximate \$3,000. Puerto Rico would also be asked to send a representative.

In the past, the General Service Office has invited certain countries outside the North America continent to send an Observer to the Annual Meeting on the General Service Conference.

As a result of considerable study, the committee believes that not much has been accomplished by this plan.

The committee believes that the needs of foreign countries can be served much better by some such plan as the one above. We recommend against issuing invitations to foreign countries to send Observers to the Conference in the future. If a foreign country asks permission to send a representative, we believe the request should be granted.

Loners and Loner Sponsors

(Beth Kuhlmann)

There are 720 Lone Members with whom we are in touch. Some months ago, an A.A. member visited G.S.O. as he was on his way overseas to become one of 422 Lone Members outside the U.S.A. and Canada.

On the other hand, there are many who are not in contact with other A.A. members except by writing to the Loner sponsors listed at G.S.O. These Loner sponsors are A.A.'s who are particularly interested in this worthwhile Twelfth Step work.

Each Loner who goes on the G.S.O. mailing list receives special material: "For the Lone Member," "Exchange Bulletin," "World Directory" and sampling of pamphlets.

They also receive a copy of the "Loners Meeting" which goes out monthly and is composed of excerpts from their own letters.

A listing of new and inactive Loners and also changes of address is sent out each month.

Internationalists' Report

(Midge McFadden)

The "Internationalists' Group" is made up of men and women who go to sea. They now number 300, an increase of over 10% since last year. Most of them join A.A. ashore and have a start on the program before they return to sea. But they are also helping alcoholics on their ships and now it is not unusual to have three or four A.A.'s on the same ship.

An up-to-date listing of these members is kept with their home address and the name of their ship, if possible. This list along with the "World Directory" is sent to members annually so they may correspond with each other, as well as find meetings or A.A. contacts in port.

New members are sent literature and personal letters from G.S.O. A publication, "The Internationalists' Round Robin," prepared bi-monthly, is made up of excerpts from their letters and distributed to all members. The February "Exchange Bulletin" article on the "Round Robin" resulted in over 300 requests for copies.

All Central Offices and Intergroups are provided with registration cards for new Internationalists and they also receive the "Round Robin."

UNITED KINGDOM

(Frank Smith)

There is no intention to "force" an Area organization in Great Britain and Ireland. The impetus comes from the Groups themselves who wish to improve Twelfth Step work and make it possible for stronger Groups to help weaker ones. It is not anticipated that a General Service Conference will come into being during the next two years, but advance planning has commenced.

The National Health Service has recognized that alcoholism is an illness. A portion of a clarifying memorandum by the Services declares: It will be necessary for the special units to run out-patient clinics and to cooperate in aftercare with Alcoholics Anonymous who have a very important contribution to make. "This is the first time in history that a specific organization has been identified by name in a Ministerial Memorandum in Great Britain."

There are now about 250 Groups in the United Kingdom and A.A. is expanding slowly but surely.

NORWAY

(Hart Sonju)

The number of Groups remains somewhat static — about 75 to 80. Where smaller Groups drop out, new ones spring up. Membership is variously estimated at from 1,500 to 3,000.

A.A. in Norway is gaining in the respect and goodwill of the authorities and the public. The A.A. Secretariat last fall circularized officials of cities, towns, counties and state bureaus, confirming that A.A. Groups and A.A. as a whole are fully self-supporting and accept no public grants. This has curbed minor violations and has tended to make the Groups increasingly alert in observance of this principle.

Approximately 200 persons attended the Norwegian National A.A. Conference held June 1 and 2 near Kristiansand on the Southernmost point of Norway. Thirty Group Delegates and seven members of the National A.A. Secretariat and the National Advisory Board attended the business session of the Conference. (The distances and cost involved in travel in Norway tend to keep Group representation low at any given Conference. However, the Conferences rotate from the north to the south over a period of years.)

Hart reported the successful conclusion of negotiations by which Norwegian A.A. acquired title to the inventory of unsold "composite" books on A.A. remaining from the edition published in 1958. It is hoped that the new arrangement will lead to wider distribution of this basic A.A. literature in Norwegian.

The Observer noted that open meetings "where strangers and those seeking information can drop in" are not customary in Norway at present.

FINLAND

(Aarne Helin)

A.A. in Finland is now in the "critical teen-age years," with occasional disappointments as well as pleasures, but 1963 was generally a very successful year. Aarne estimated that A.A. activity in his country is at about the same level as that in British Columbia, Georgia, Iowa, Kansas, Louisiana, Maryland or Oklahoma.

The service structure in Finland was changed two years ago. There are now two separate committees; one responsible for work with alcoholics and the other responsible for publishing and "corporate" affairs. Quarterly "general conferences" are held, of which the January meeting constitutes the annual meeting. All Groups are invited to attend. In addition, there are eight separate monthly Area meetings.

FRANCE

(Nick Hall)

Nick reviewed briefly the sudden surge in French-speaking A.A. in France as a result of the 1960 newspaper articles by Joseph Kessel. During the past three years most of the A.A. activity has centered around Paris, where the first Group was established. In addition to the original Quai d'Orsay Group, the Belleville Group on the outskirts of the city appears to be thriving. There are also Groups in Bordeaux, Marseilles, Roubaix, Rouen and Tourcoing.

There are perhaps 100 to 150 active members in Paris. Other French Groups, plus a few Loners, account for possibly 50 additional members. "Growth will be slow at first but, in Paris especially, it is solid growth based on a deep understanding of the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions. An encouraging augury for the future is that the French medical profession at long last is beginning to evidence an interest in A.A., judging by the number of doctors attending public meetings."

Approximately ten members of the Quai d'Orsay Group celebrated third anniversaries last fall. This year some will celebrate their fourth. More than 60 have had first or second anniversaries.

"There were pessimists who argued that A.A. could not succeed in France. It was said the French were not 'joiners'; that social lines were too rigid to permit the inclusion in a single Group of individuals of such diverse social and economic backgrounds as is normal in A.A." The pessimists, it would appear, were wrong.

SWEDEN

(Axel Skantze)

A.A. in Sweden has progressed unusually rapidly in the early part of 1964. This is particularly due to two radio programs broadcast by the national network early in January. The programs, entitled "We are Alcoholics" and "Sober 24 Hours," were aired in the evening a week apart.

The result was overwhelming and, at the request of many listeners outside of A.A., both programs were broadcast again in March.

New Groups have been started in many parts of Sweden and it is especially gratifying to note the increased number of young people among the newcomers. The average age has been lowered considerably. Most of the new members were especially attracted by our anonymity principles. They felt assured that their own identities would not be disclosed in any way.

Another very promising feature is the increased interest in A.A. by doctors, hospitals, clergymen, lawyers, also a president of an institute of learning. The inquiries have been made either by telephone or mail both to the Swedish Broadcasting Company and directly to A.A.

Many newcomers have come to A.A. at the suggestion of doctors whom we had never heard of before.

There is an active literature program, including a Finnish version of the "Grapevine." A Finnish "Big Book" has been in circulation for more than a year, replacing an earlier mimeographed edition. Institutional work is progressing; there are now 27 Groups in correctional institutions.

A revised edition of "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions" in Finnish was received from the printers in January of this year. Literature in Swedish is also available for the 9 per cent of the Finnish population who use that language.

Of immediate special interest are plans for a Scandinavian A.A. Conference, to be held in Jonkoping, Sweden, this fall. Representatives of all Groups in Scandinavia will be invited to attend.

G.S.O. Information Activities

(Anita Ryan)

More than 6,000 inquiries were received at the General Service Office in 1963. Over two-thirds of these were from students, on grammar school, high school and college levels. A number asked for enough material for an entire class. There were also letters from teachers, alcoholics, families and friends of alcoholics, doctors, clergymen, librarians, researchers and writers. Each inquiry was acknowledged with a letter and appropriate literature.

Alcoholics Anonymous was mentioned in 3,322 domestic and 1,121 foreign newspaper stories sent to us by our press clipping bureau. There was an increase in anonymity breaks, which might indicate a need for another general mailing to the communications media explaining A.A.'s Tradition. Many of the breaks occurred in news items covering luncheons of Kiwanis, Rotary, etc., at which A.A. members spoke.

During 1963, our two A.A. professional exhibits were shown at eight national professional meetings and at one state health fair.

American Association of School Administrators
American Orthopsychiatric Association
Health Fair, Connecticut
National Council on Alcoholism
National League for Nursing
National Conference on Social Welfare
National Education Association
American Hospital Association
American Public Health Association

At three of these meetings, Delegates took the responsibility of having local A.A.'s available to man the exhibit. Special interest in Alcoholics Anonymous was shown at the National League for Nursing meeting in Atlantic City in May. Over 900 student and graduate nurses filled out forms requesting pamphlets.

Nurses are also seeking further information and understanding at the 1964 meeting of the American Nurses Association by having a speaker on "Alcoholics Anonymous, a Resource for the Alcoholic."

Tape Service

(Anita Ryan)

Last spring plans had just been completed for making tape recordings available from G.S.O. Eight tapes were listed at \$2.50 each. Five are talks on personal recovery and three are special talks, including the A.A. meeting held during the 1963 General Service Conference.

Interest and purchase were much greater than anticipated, and the original inventory was quickly depleted. Over 100 reels were sold of each of the tapes and over 200 of each of the first two personal recovery talks listed. There were approximately 400 orders for a total of 1,350 tapes.

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

(Mary Bernson)

Chairman: Corporate Board

For the first time in its history, the Grapevine has a surplus, and there is no longer a capital deficit on the books. A net gain of approximately \$22,000.00 for the year made it possible to discharge the long standing debt of \$11,570.41 to the General Service Board.

Circulation figures indicate a healthy growth.

Group Records and Directory

Since the last report, there has been a net gain of 886 Groups, bringing the total number in the spring of 1964 to 10,956.

This indeed is growth and although communication between A.A. Groups and G.S.O. is in better shape, there is still room for improvement.

This year, planning for the "World Directory" started earlier, and these were the procedures set up:

1. Group information cards had a new format which made it possible for Groups to indicate their G.S.R.'s on reverse side, together with notes on the information needed for Directory purposes. No other instructions were needed by the person filling out the card.
2. Cards were mailed to Groups in September, 1963 for return by December 16.
3. G.S.O. asked for the mailing address for Groups and two telephone contacts.
4. A Directory letter in nine languages went out for the first time.
5. Groups were asked to locate their Group in a General Service Conference Area. Response was good, but many Groups did not know what Area they were in.

One of the principal problems of Group Records remains unsolved. That is the current practice of mailing to Group Secretaries and to G.S.R.'s. As the G.S.R. list grows, our mailing list mushrooms; it is now approximately 20,000.

A new, less costly Directory format has been adopted. Delegates and Chairmen of General Service Conference Area Committees are listed in the Directory and, for the first time, all Delegates are listed.

The "A.A. Exchange Bulletin"

(Hazel Rice)

The "A.A. Exchange Bulletin," with news and notes on A.A. worldwide, is a vital means of communication for G.S.O. The Bulletin is mailed to the total G.S.O. mailing list which currently numbers 18,500, and includes all Groups, G.S.R.'s, Committee Members, etc.:

- a. Providing information on new and revised A.A. literature and service material.
- b. Sharing reports of service activities involving Public Information, Groups, Overseas, Prisons and Hospitals, Loners, Internationalists, General Service Conference, Finances, General Service Board, A.A. World Services and the "Grapevine."
- c. Requesting current information and experience to answer more effectively the questions received in correspondence at G.S.O.
- d. Reporting growth, trends and news of A.A. worldwide.

The "Exchange Bulletin" is a joint Staff effort, with one Staff Member serving as Editor.

The April-May Bulletin has three columns per page. Purpose: better presentation of more short items.

Currently, plans are to publish seven issues in 1964 - January, February, April-May, July-August, September-October, November and December. With a steadily mounting mailing list, reaction and response to the Bulletin mailings are watched carefully and issues will be increased in number only if the need is indicated.

Trustees' Committees

FINANCE

Archibald B. Roosevelt — chairman
Eugene Kelley, co-chairman
Mary Bernson
Robert Kelby
Charles E. Lalanne, Jr.
Herbert A. Morse
Thomas A. Sharpe
Wilbur Smith — ex-officio
Midge McFadden — secretary

LITERATURE

Ivan Underwood — chairman
David Bancroft, co-chairman
Yvelin Gardner, The Rev.
Don Goddard
James Masterson
Jay Jacobs
Herbert A. Morse
Harrison Trice
Murray Whitsett
Hazel Rice — secretary

NOMINATING

Austin MacCormick — chairman
Eugene Kelley
Roy Scovil
Herbert A. Morse
Thomas Sharpe
Gurney Williams
Eve Marsh — secretary

POLICY

Thomas A. Sharpe — chairman
David Bancroft
Mary Bernson
Eve Marsh
James Masterson
Herbert A. Morse
Roy Scovil
Dr. Harry Tiebout
Gurney Williams
Beth Kuhlmann — secretary

INTERNATIONAL COMMITTEE

(Subcommittee of the Policy Committee)

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Allan Bachman, co-chairman
Adrian Frylink
Midge McFadden
Herbert A. Morse
Niles Peebles
Hazel Rice — secretary

General Service Board

(Dr. John L. Norris
Chairman)

Following are some of the recommendations approved by the General Service Board during the past year:

1. That a new and revised pamphlet on the same general subject as "Tranquilizers, Sedatives and the Alcoholic" be prepared with the help of A.A. World Services, the Literature Committee and competent experts in the medical field.
2. That an additional day be set up for the 1964 Conference, with the decision on future Conferences to be reserved.
3. That permission be denied Arthur Cain to reprint excerpts from "The A.A. Grapevine" and Conference approved literature in his forthcoming book. Reason: To stay within our Tenth Tradition that A.A. never be drawn into public controversy.
4. That "A.A.'s Report to the Public" released annually since 1961 be dated to follow the Trustees' meeting in April. The report is printed and used by the G.S.O. Staff in replying to inquiries throughout the year.
5. That the Board of Trustees accept with regret the resignation of Class A Trustee, Dr. Harvey Cruickshank, because of ill health and new executive responsibilities.
6. That an estimated total membership of "more than 350,000" be used in releases and in all literature and correspondence.
7. That the six-member International Committee (authorized by the Board as a subcommittee of the Policy Committee to study A.A. outside the U.S. and Canada) be authorized to investigate the practicability of a "workshop" for representatives of some Central and South American countries.
8. That \$14,000 be transferred from the General Fund to offset the deficit in Group account for 1963.
9. That Dr. Norris chair a study committee to examine the Board's position regarding rotation of Class A Trustees.

Extended Conference Approved for 1965

The 1964 Conference, opening on a Tuesday and closing on a Sunday afternoon, was the longest in A.A. history. The experiment of adding a day to the Conference program had been approved last year in view of the growing number of matters now being referred to Delegates for their consideration. Even with the additional time available, the 1964 agenda was a tight one; evening sessions were scheduled on three of the four week days.

A recommendation that the 1965 Conference be programmed for the same number of days as the 1964 meeting was adopted unanimously.

'AREA HIGHLIGHTS' PRESENTATIONS BY DELEGATES

In recent years, first-year Delegates have been invited to submit to the Conference brief reports on A.A. in their Areas. Following are digests of presentations by Panel 14 Delegates.

MISSISSIPPI — Bish Mathis

Mississippi is building an active, functioning committee. G.S.R.'s and Committee Members are busy. Weak Groups have been strengthened and new ones have been formed. Districts have become active and "Round Robins" have been started. The broad scope of the Fellowship has been stressed.

NEBRASKA — Don Marquard

Nebraska Area communication has been strengthened and improved, partially due to the increase in the number of districts and Committee Members from eight to twelve. Further strength has been added by support of individual Group anniversaries and planning and support of the annual State Reunion. "We know that only through uniting will A.A. grow and prosper at all levels."

NEW MEXICO — Darrell McCleskey

A Sharing Session was held during the State Semi-annual Assembly meeting in Albuquerque in September. The meeting was attended by more than 50 per cent of the Groups in the state. Roy Scovil, the Southwestern Regional Trustee, was the main speaker, highlighting A.A. responsibilities at the local, state and national level. The afternoon session was devoted to a "Round Robin" during which Representatives asked questions and expressed opinions on various Group problems.

VERMONT — Pete Dewey

The Delegate, Committee Members and G.S.R.'s should be active and trustworthy. They or the Alternate should attend each Assembly meeting. The officers should take up with their Groups the pros and cons of the Assembly meeting. The Representatives should let the Delegate know of the Groups' feelings and actions.

NORTH DAKOTA — Gordon LaMont

Lack of knowledge on the part of the individual member concerning the importance of the A.A. structure in assuring the future growth of A.A. has hampered communication within the Area. "We must try to remedy this situation by doing everything we can to carry the message of world service and the A.A. structure of communication to every Group and member in our Areas. We must solicit help . . . by calling on former Delegates to speak to the Groups."

KENTUCKY — Hugh Alderson

Kentucky is divided into nine districts, each having a Committee Member at the quarterly business meetings. One project is furnishing A.A. literature to hospitals and correctional institutions; another is sending speakers into weaker districts to stimulate interest in Area meetings. Groups in western Kentucky meet monthly with an outstanding speaker; business is conducted by a Steering Committee.

KANSAS — Sharon Foster

An Area Committee "Sharing Session" was devoted to the question: "When a Group's attendance has fallen off, how can it take steps to rebuild?" Among the suggestions: Hold a "Sharing Session" on the problem and develop ways for distributing the ideas that result from the sessions.

WESTERN MICHIGAN — Ed Laubenthal

Area Committee meetings are held the third Sunday of every other month, at 10 o'clock in the morning; the Intergroup monthly business meeting and the Al-Anon meeting are held at one o'clock, and the speaker meeting an hour later. Plans are under way to promote a program for reading and discussing the "Third Legacy Manual," "The Twelve Concepts" and to increase understanding of the Twelve Traditions.

NORTHERN WISCONSIN & UPPER MICHIGAN — Robert Zeugner

Monthly Intergroup meetings, rotated throughout the Area, have recently been inaugurated. Many worthwhile ideas and viewpoints have been exchanged. A.A. has been recognized by the prisons, mental institutions and hospitals; regular meetings have been welcomed. The administrator of the state-supported "Referral Center" is an alcoholic who, with the consistent help of judges and the courts, has helped many alcoholics.

PUERTO RICO — Charlie Carballo

A.A. is growing in the Area, with some growing pains. "Third Legacy Manual" suggestions and methods were unknown to many. In the past there have been some misinformation and lack of understanding. Recently, however, Third Legacy methods have been tried, with promising results.

SOUTHWEST TEXAS — Tommy Thompson

We have found that the best way to reach the public with information on Alcoholics Anonymous is through organizations such as Lions Clubs, through clergymen of all denominations, through public school teachers and students and by inviting the public to open meetings.

NEW JERSEY — SOUTH — Ruth Day

There are four districts in the Area, each with an effective answering service. Atlantic City has had A.A. exhibits at conventions and lists meetings in newspapers. Trenton and Camden have radio programs weekly. A public information meeting for doctors, clergymen and the general public attracted more than 200 persons. Speakers have been furnished for many organizations. The Area participated in the annual State Convention on Alcoholism.

MONTANA — Judy Machler

A "Sharing Session" was held and a follow-up report was sent to all G.S.R.'s and Loners. We encourage G.S.R.'s to make the report to the Groups and attack the problem of communication by using the mails to "carry the message." By being consistent in these procedures, we foresee that there will be more unity among Montana Groups.

OREGON — Bill Griffith

The State Chairman and Delegate work with Committee Members to set up Area meetings throughout the state. Meetings are devoted entirely to an explanation of A.A. service. The Delegate gives a general talk on services; the State Chairman follows with a talk on the need for support to carry on these services. Results are gratifying.

ILLINOIS — DOWNSTATE — Bruce Wight

In the past Area Committee meetings have not been sufficiently attractive to draw large attendance. It is hoped that well-organized "Sharing Sessions," in which all who attend would be expected to participate, will prove more successful.

WESTERN MASSACHUSETTS — Leo Burns

A "General Service Round-up" was held in the Area, with gratifying results. All former Delegates participated. The film-strip provided by G.S.O. was used in conjunction with appropriate commentary by all former Delegates. G.S.R.'s handled publicity at the Group level very effectively.

WESTERN NEW YORK — George Schnatz

The Area comprises 11 districts who send representatives to ten monthly Assemblies each year. The meeting place is rotated, covering all sections of the Area. Each month all G.S.R.'s and Committee Members receive minutes of the previous meeting. In addition to discussing Group and Area problems, the meetings consider correspondence received from G.S.O. by the Delegate.

'AREA HIGHLIGHTS' PRESENTATIONS BY DELEGATES

SOUTHERN COASTAL CALIFORNIA — Tom Allen

Notices of meetings in our district were sent out at least two weeks prior to the meeting. A current directory was a necessity. Meetings last from two to four hours, giving each G.S.R. an opportunity to be heard. We made it a point to review the G.S.R.'s duties, as outlined in the "Third Legacy Manual."

ATLANTIC PROVINCES, CANADA — Bob Clayton

Communications in the Atlantic Area have not been good. The size of these four provinces (more than 200,000 square miles) has been a contributing factor. There was some improvement last year when each of the provinces held a "Round-up" at which the Delegate presented his report.

QUEBEC, CANADA — Robert Roy

French Groups now number 165 and are increasing steadily. Most of the literature, including the Big Book, has been translated. A monthly Exchange Bulletin in French reaches all our Groups. Plans are being considered for a special quarterly edition of the "Grapevine" in French. "Our translation work has established a line of communication with all the French-speaking countries of the world."

QUEBEC, CANADA — Bill Burns

A.A. in Quebec now enjoys the understanding of more religious and social agencies in the Area. Separate language Groups and bilingual service centers are established. A.A. is cooperating with a study and information committee on alcoholism set up by the provincial government. A local Public Information Committee helps "carry the message" in weekly and suburban papers. Strengthening of A.A. in the English-speaking sector is being encouraged.

GEORGIA — Heflin Daniel

We are in process of redistricting the state, according to activity rather than geography. We plan to have state business meeting, quarterly in Macon, our most centrally located city. We plan to select our Delegate at these meetings, rather than at the state Convention, as in the past, and believe this will stimulate more representation and participation by G.S.R.'s and Committee Members.

NORTHERN CALIFORNIA INTERIOR — Rick Schreiber

Progress is certainly the "highlight" of this area. Response to General Service during the past two and a half years has exceeded our fondest hopes. Outgoing Committee officers and Committee Members, aided by several former Delegates, have played important roles in these developments.

NEW HAMPSHIRE — Doris Gurnsey

There is a lack of interest in the Delegate's own Group as far as Committees outside the local Area are concerned. Travel distance may be a factor. The Delegate hopes to generate a feeling of interest in Area activity and is seeking suggestions.

SOUTH DAKOTA — Jake Steinberg

The success of the treatment program at our state hospital has been a highlight of our activity in "carrying the message" about A.A. to the public. The large percentage of patients who return to their home communities to become active, often ardent, members of a local A.A. Group is most rewarding. New Groups have been started by former patients. Radio and television stations in the state have also helped to inform the public about A.A.

RHODE ISLAND — Fred Watson

Both public information and public relations are important. "If, through our way of life, we can create a climate of happy and grateful sobriety, we can offset the climate of drinking that has invaded all areas of living."

NORTHWEST OHIO — Elmer Larson (Alternate)

Intergroup helps solve Area or Group problems in the traditional way. The "Toledo Area News" provides both Groups and members with a full report on Area activity. Monthly "all-Group" meetings give each member an opportunity to meet new friends and exchange A.A. experience. Our Central Office is the hub of all communication to Groups and to nonalcoholics.

NORTHWEST TEXAS — Ralph Gordon

Area Committee communication is rather difficult, due to the size of the Area (about 400 by 250 miles). Regional A.A. meetings (Round Robin meetings) have been held for some years. Six cities are on the circuit and the meetings are rotated, providing a large meeting in the Area each month. Recently, Committee meetings have been scheduled during the meetings. Committee Members, G.S.R.'s and other interested members may attend. Attendance has been good and more interest and enthusiasm have been created.

SASKATCHEWAN, CANADA — John Tkachuk

Two "Sharing Sessions" were held in Saskatchewan during the past year. I found we really didn't know as much as we thought we knew about the different aspects of A.A. Area Meetings are held four times a year. We are trying to move closer to the Twelve Traditions. Our institutions are being looked after well. Public information activity has really grown.

NORTHERN MINNESOTA — Donald Formo (Alternate)

"Sharing Sessions" are included as part of our weekly meetings. They have helped many of us to overcome our fears to speak out without the aid of a bottle. "Sharing Sessions" have also helped to hold together the nine Groups in our Area and promote better understanding of General Service and its functions.

ALBERTA, CANADA — Martin Elgeti

A new Area Bulletin, "Alberta Roundup," will be mailed out to all members in the Area as part of the Area communications program. Plans are under way to enlist the aid of Area Committee Members in setting up meetings, in sparsely settled sections, at which the Delegate will be able to discuss local and international service responsibilities with Committee Members.

IDAHO — Arnold Teeple

A.A. has been in Idaho for 17 years. There are 355 active members in 26 Groups. Of the latter, 19 Groups participate in state activities. Seven Groups in the northwestern part of the state are in Washington and Oregon Areas. "A.A. in Idaho is as straight out of the Big Book as a punch in the nose . . . as close to our Twelve Traditions as human frailty permits."

CALIFORNIA — SAN DIEGO — Frank Surman

"In this Area we have practically 100 per cent coverage of facilities where alcoholics are confined, but we do not receive 'enough' requests for our speakers from colleges, civic organizations, employers and civic clubs." There is some concern whether the Area is doing enough to reach alcoholics who have not yet "hit bottom." "Are we doing enough toward carrying the message?"

ALASKA — Claude Millsap

Despite communications problems in the largest state in the Union, membership again doubled during the past year, due primarily to a hard core of dedicated A.A.'s who "carry the message" throughout the state. There is an A.A. contact or Group in nearly every community. More and more members from other states appear at meetings, strengthening local Groups and adding to their maturity.

'AREA HIGHLIGHTS' PRESENTATIONS BY DELEGATES

WESTERN ONTARIO, CANADA — Cliff Morris

With the establishment of two Area Assemblies for all G.S.R.'s, there has been a marked improvement in communications in the Area during the past year. A provincial publication, "All Around Ontario," with a circulation of 4,500, helps to unify A.A. in the Area. A new Ontario General Service Committee has been formed. It will comprise three Delegates, three Alternate Delegates and one immediate past Delegate, to act as chairman. Biannual meetings will be held.

MARYLAND — Milton Hause

There are now A.A. Groups in six penal institutions in Maryland, all stemming directly from a Group organized in the Maryland Penitentiary in 1951, following an inmate's correspondence with G.S.O. All Groups have waiting lists for admittance. (Inmates must be "cleared" by prison officials.) An Institutional Committee supports A.A. activities in seven hospitals. One pet project in Baltimore is Chip House, conceived as a way of helping the derelict alcoholic who wishes to stop drinking.

SOUTHWEST OHIO — Harold Stump

Public Information Committees have been established in metropolitan Cincinnati and in the greater Dayton area, with the Delegate, Area Committee Members and Group officers handling P.I.C. activities in the central part of the Area. Central offices are cooperative, members have participated in television and radio programs and on panels for the benefit of hospital personnel, doctors, clergymen, industrialists and court officers. Regular daytime open meetings are held as part of the public information program.

ARIZONA — Leo Rayburn

A.A. has been growing by leaps and bounds in Arizona during the past few years; there are now 79 Groups with approximately 1,250 active members. There are two rehabilitation houses for men and one for women alcoholics. The Institutional Committee has been extremely active; in less than four years, the number of Groups in institutions has grown from one to 13. G.S.R.'s have been very active in all phases of A.A. in Arizona.

MANITOBA, CANADA — Ross Marr

A.A. in the Area has grown rapidly. More than 1,000 attended the Provincial Roundup in Winnipeg in October. G.S.R. meetings are held twice a year. With about 45 Groups in the Area, 35 to 40 G.S.R.'s attend these meetings. Prison authorities are 100% cooperative. We have favorable connections with doctors, nurses, hospital administrators and police officials. The Alcoholism Foundation of Manitoba has been of untold value in referring alcoholics to A.A.

NEW YORK — HUDSON-MOHAWK-BERKSHIRE — Frank Hogan

"Action is the magic word." Attendance at monthly Intergroup meetings has increased since the Area Committee and the G.S.R.'s adopted a plan to hold their meetings in conjunction with Area Intergroup meetings. Printing of Area schedules and setting up Intergroup meeting schedules kept G.S.R.'s and the Area Committee busy during the winter.

ILLINOIS CHICAGO AREA — Paul Martin

The Intergroup and the Chicago Metropolitan Rotating Committee have worked out an arrangement for alternately selecting General Service Conference Delegates. Paul also noted that a 20-bed ward for alcoholic women has been established in Chicago State Hospital, a notable "first." A.A.'s in the Area are providing special assistance, including literature.

TENNESSEE — Wayne Reed

A.A. is growing in the State. There are now 59 Groups with a total active membership of 910 members. Many referrals are being received from the State Mental Health Department and the State Alcoholism Commission. Despite growth, there is still lack of understanding of General Services but approaches to this problem are being made. Monthly Area meetings, open to the public, have created much interest in A.A.

WYOMING — David Thompson

Progress is being made statewide. A.A. is represented in all state correctional institutions, as a result of an exceptional job by the Institutional Committee. Geography poses some problems but "we will keep moving ahead."

DELAWARE — Richard Boyce

A.A. unity in Delaware is increasingly strong. Three "very successful Assembly meetings" in recent years have been a factor in this. Meetings in correctional institutions have been rescheduled after a lapse of several months. These meetings are an important part of the service program.

MAINE — Ken Sanders (Alternate)

There are four A.A. districts in the Area, each of which holds a monthly meeting to discuss problems common to Groups represented, and to encourage "exchange meetings." There are two Statewide meetings a year. A monthly letter goes to all Groups from the State Committee, which also meets at least once a year with the district units.

SOUTH CAROLINA — Ceth Mason

This year a committee of former Delegates has been set up to meet with G.S.R.'s for "Sharing Sessions" and to discuss the agendas of state meetings, which are held quarterly. There appears to be great value in utilizing former Delegates in this manner. Increased cooperation, but non-affiliation, with Al-Anon has also been productive in some parts of the State.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

As in the past, all Delegates had an opportunity to obtain specific information — anonymously, if desired — by placing questions in a special container, the "Ask-It Basket." Following are answers to 1964 questions of movement-wide interest.

Anonymity

A history of A.A. in a particular area is being written and distributed to A.A. members and Groups only. Is it permissible to use full names of members?

Sense of the meeting was that anonymity should be maintained.

Census

Would the Arizona Delegate describe how a count of A.A. members was taken in his state?

All Area Committee Members and G.S.R.'s were asked to take a census at meetings for a period of one week. At the end of each meeting, the G.S.R. asked members present who had not been asked elsewhere, to raise their hands. Visitors were counted also. Committee Members gave total to the Delegate. Out of 79 Groups, only one Group did not participate. This census revealed a 37% increase in membership.

Clubs

What should be done with money taken out of the Treasury to remodel a clubroom and given back by the landlord when the club was asked to move? The Group now rents a furnished clubroom and is unable to agree on who actually put up the money in the first place. This is causing trouble in the Group.

It was suggested a business meeting of the voting members of the Group be called and have them vote on the most acceptable method of disposing of the money.

Should clubs be listed in the "World Directory"?

Clubs are listed for convenience of traveling members and because many meetings are held in clubrooms.

What should be done when one of the large Groups with a large clubhouse doesn't want the Delegate to make his report?

There is nothing the Delegate can do, but try to keep the lines of communication open. Possibly the Group will co-operate in a Sharing Session to get answers to some local problem.

Directory

Should ex-Delegates receive the "World Directory" at no charge?

The consensus was that ex-Delegates should pay for the Directory.

Can suburban Groups be listed in the Directory under their own names or should they come under the name of the nearby large city?

G.S.O. will be glad to cross reference such Groups if they wish it to be done.

Should each Committee Member receive the "World Directory" (as far as expense is concerned)?

Large majority of Delegates felt Committee Members should continue to receive the Directory.

Finance

According to a magazine article published recently, we pay our Manager of General Services \$18,000 a year for part-time work, 3½ days per week. Is this true? It seems as though \$103 per day is a little high for part-time work.

The Manager of G.S.O. commented on the salary levels of the G.S.O. Staff, pointing out that they were consistent with those paid for positions of comparable skills in com-

merce and other non-profit organizations. (In passing he noted that his own hours in 1963 ran 88% of full time.) The Conference passed a unanimous vote of confidence. Bill expressed his appreciation of the Conference's endorsement of his compensation recommendations as they appear in the Twelve Concepts.

Is it possible to make a more detailed explanation of the "pie chart" showing the breakdown of the budget?

This will be done. (At the same time Delegates expressed approval of the new money folder, "You—Your Group—and A.A. Worldwide.")

Do Delegates encourage the Birthday Plan? If not, why not?

A show of hands indicated that many Delegates favored the Birthday Plan for use in their Areas. Several spoke of good results and said that it was particularly good for smaller Groups where it might be the only contribution Plan used. (Delegates were shown one of the plastic Birthday boxes now available from G.S.O.)

Is it possible for G.S.O. to furnish containers of some kind for Group contributions?

Not practical to ship containers. However, various kinds of containers used for collecting Group contributions were described at the Joint Finance Committee meeting. Many ideas were mentioned: coffee cans, jars and bottle of various descriptions. Delegates were invited to send in any ideas they have or methods used in their Areas.

My husband wants to know once and for all what, if any, portion of my A.A. contributions, travel and other expenses are tax deductible.

(Two questions are involved here: (1) Travel on General Service work, and (2) Travel to Group meetings)

(1) The Delegate from Oklahoma reported that the I.R.S. will allow deductions up to 20% of gross income for contributions or travel expense. He said, "the code is clear that all expenses devoted to service of a tax-exempt organization such as A.A., are deductible, provided there is no reimbursement." There must be complete documentation of necessary expense: travel receipts, for lodging, meals, mileage, over and above compensated expenses. (A similar question asked at last year's Conference is pertinent here. The question and detailed answer can be found on page 23 of the 1963 Conference Report.)

(2) Another category, involving travel and medical expense, should be treated separately. A recent ruling (Rev. Rul. 63-273) allowed travel expense to an A.A. member who joined A.A. on his doctor's advice, that membership was necessary to treat "a disease involving the excessive use of alcoholic liquor." Transportation costs paid in attending meetings of that Group were deductible, subject to the usual limitations on medical deductions and to local interpretation.

Would it be possible to send a memorial contribution to G.S.O. collected from various Groups?

Yes. G.S.O. does accept A.A. memorial contributions from A.A. members and a card is sent to the family.

In the preamble of A.A. we say "There are no dues or fees." This is taken to mean that we do not need funds. We should state that each A.A. member has a responsibility to support his Fellowship.

The Finance Committee is working on a "self-support" statement for use at Group meetings.

What are the sources of A.A. income?

There are four main categories: two sources of contributions (from regular Groups and "special" contributions from state meetings, etc.), income from publishing, and yield on the Reserve Fund.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

For all her years of devoted service, has Ann Macfarlane been looked after by A.A. financially during her well-deserved leave of absence?

Ann has been a Staff Member for 16 years. She is receiving one-half her salary while on this year's leave. The cost to G.S.O. is \$1150, representing the difference between her salary and a new Staff Member's starting salary. In 1965, when Eve takes her leave of absence, she will also receive one-half her yearly salary.

I notice that Illinois has 92% Group contributions. Please tell us how you do so well in this department.

It was explained that the Chicago Central Office Group reports for all Groups affiliated with it (as one Group).

General Service Conference

Can G.S.O. advise all Groups within a Conference-approved geographical Area to become associated with that Area Assembly? In one Area, for instance, some Groups contributed to one Assembly, voted in another.

Membership in Area Assemblies is primarily a matter of communication. Although boundaries of the Areas were drawn up on statewide and provincial lines, many Groups have affiliated with the Assembly with which they have the best communication. G.S.O. has never tried to change this. However, the question is one that requires further study and discussion.

Why don't we consider a three-year term for Delegates?

This failed of passage at the 1959 Conference. This was discussed further at the "Area Delegates Only" meeting. No decision was reached.

Can Delegates be notified of newspaper or magazine articles to be discussed at coming Conferences so they can read them in advance?

Yes. This has been done in the past and articles will be made available again in the future when there is a probability they will be discussed.

How do Area Committees establish successful communications with their Groups?

It was suggested that Groups be made to feel a necessary part of the service picture, by encouraging and increasing participation of new Groups and helping them to become active in service affairs.

How many Delegates and Class B Trustees are on their Area's Twelfth Step call list?

A show of hands revealed that more than half the Delegates and Class B Trustees, as well as a good part of the G.S.O. Staff, are on call.

Can an A.A. member be a chairman of a General Service Assembly even though he is not affiliated with a Group?

It was noted that the usual procedure according to the Third Legacy Manual is for G.S.R.'s to be elected by their Groups. They in turn select Committee officers. The Manual states that this is suggested procedure. Each area is autonomous and each Assembly can establish its own rules, subject to the wishes of the entire Assembly.

Is it possible to maintain greater similarity between the preliminary list of subjects for discussion during the Conference and subjects on the final Agenda?

G.S.O. will try to watch this carefully so Delegates may come well prepared.

Can the full Conference Report (3-ring binder and presentations) be made available to district Committee Members and ex-Delegates on a cost basis?

Delegates did not see any clear need for this. One Delegate felt, however, that the Alternate Delegate should receive this material.

Should a G.S.R. resign when he is elected a Committee Member?

A show of hands revealed a majority of Areas encourage the election of a new G.S.R. where one has been made a Committee Member.

In some Areas, there seems to be a feeling of competition between local hospitals, Institutional Committees and Area Committees instead of cooperation. What is the solution?

It was felt that where the Institutional Committee worked in cooperation with either a local Intergroup or an Area Committee so that experience could be shared, a good working relationship could be established.

Could the Conference have the flags of the overseas Observers present in the Conference room?

Delegates said they would be delighted to have the flags.

How can a G.S.R. get the Groups more interested in world services?

This was discussed at length at this Conference. The G.S.R. is a vital link between the local Group and G.S.O. He keeps the Group informed about General Services and helps to maintain interest in activities of G.S.O., as well as in his Area Committee affairs.

Who has the "final say" on the Agenda?

"Final say" resides with the Conference chairman and vice-chairman, Conference Agenda Committee and the General Service Board. One Delegate felt that the Conference members themselves should have the final say.

It is possible to have a joint session of Agenda and other Conference committees such as the Joint Finance Committees had?

Such conferring has been done successfully by mail thus far. This kind of joint meeting requires time and preparation. It should be held only for the discussion of critical questions.

What does the Conference think about setting a time limit before a new Group can send a G.S.R. to a State Assembly meeting to elect a Delegate?

One Delegate suggested that Groups not listed in the Directory at the time of the Assembly should not be recognized. Another opinion was a qualification of three months or more in order to vote.

What is the feeling of having proxy G.S.R.'s representing Institutional Groups?

The majority indicated that in their Areas an outside A.A. sponsor is allowed to act as proxy, representing an individual Institutional Group at Area Assemblies.

General Service Office

Can Interim Reports of the Board of Trustees be sent earlier to the State Committee and Delegates?

Yes. This will be done.

What can be done to avoid duplicate mailing by G.S.O.?

G.S.O. is working on a better coding plan to eliminate duplication. One Delegate suggested that Committee Members and G.S.R.'s notify G.S.O. immediately when duplicate mailings are received.

Can G.S.O. put more emphasis on services to local Groups and individuals and less on world services in order to help get contributions from members who are not sold on world services?

Referring to the "pie chart" in the new money folder, it was pointed out that 90.25% of all effort and money is invested in Groups in the U.S. and Canada. The dramatic quality of A.A. overseas frequently results in the appearance of more emphasis on world service than is actually the case.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

Can G.S.O. make one or two motion pictures similar to "A Day at a Time" which can be made available to the Groups?

This would cost in excess of \$25,000 — there is no place for such an expense in the G.S.O. budget at the present time.

Is it possible for the "Exchange Bulletin" to be mailed out with the "Grapevine"?

This is not practical because the "Exchange Bulletin" and the "Grapevine" go to different addresses.

Would it be possible to receive the "Exchange Bulletin" at a bulk price?

G.S.O. will explore this.

Can G.S.O. make available a tape recording on the Steps and another on the Traditions?

This is in the works and G.S.O. will be reporting on this.

Grapevine

Does the retiring Delegate always become the Grapevine Representative?

No. This can be the case, but each Group and Area is autonomous and thus makes its own choice.

Do the Twelve Concepts for World Service apply to the "Grapevine"? If so, does the Grapevine Staff have moral rights of "participation" and "decision" in choosing the editor?

Yes. Corporate Grapevine Board includes two Staff Members. Responsibility is consistent with job. There is no worry about rights unless it is in a legal sense. They are inherent in the structure of the Grapevine Board.

Delegates are more interested in and concerned with what we see in Grapevine's pages each month than in the necessary record keeping and business operation. At next year's Conference, could we have six speakers on contents of Grapevine and one on business?

Agenda Committee for the Conference will give attention to this.

In 1958 the Conference recommended a change in the name of General Service Headquarters to General Service Office. Hundreds of G.S.R.'s have worked hard to persuade A.A. members that G.S.O. is not a headquarters but a central clearing office. Now the May "Grapevine" with its article "Deacon and the Delegate" revives the idea that G.S.O. sees itself as the Headquarters of A.A. This is an affront to Conference wishes and a disservice to G.S.O.

The Grapevine said the article was not meant to convey this impression. It was written in a light vein, wanted to give information to readers. The word "headquarters" was used only once to start the ball rolling.

Group Affairs

What should be done with the left-over funds of a Group which meets only during vacation months?

Three suggestions were offered that represented most Delegates' experience: (1) Send these funds to G.S.O. (2) Send half to local Intergroup and half to G.S.O. (3) Send 25 per cent to state fund and 75 per cent to G.S.O.

Should G.S.O. send out notices warning members about excessive deductions for contributions to A.A.?

No.

Should local or Area Conferences be plugged during a television program about A.A.?

Not plugged, no. But conferences frequently provide an opportunity to make available information about A.A.

Is there a need to clarify the difference between a Central Office and an Intergroup? For example, a Central Office usually has office space and personnel, while an Intergroup may be a meeting of Group representatives or just a committee. Would it be advisable to suggest that Areas refer to their own

offices as "Area" or "Central" Offices, rather than as "Service Office" in order to avoid confusion?

While this is a matter of local autonomy, it is recognized that differences of opinion and confusion exist regarding the description and functions of such offices in many Areas. In some Areas a Central Office is set up as a corporation to run the office setup on behalf of the local Groups, and an Intergroup Association is only a committee. In other Areas there is no difference in function. A California Delegate detailed the growth of the Central Office in his Area before the Third Legacy Plan was operative there and described the structure of each setup. However, it was pointed out that both are engaged in local offices, also provide services.

What factors should be considered before starting a new Group?

The first point is to establish the need for a Group. It is also important for those starting the Group to follow through and guide it in the early days. At the same time, they should be careful not to be too protective. It was also suggested a public meeting be put on to help the Group.

Should a Group's first responsibility be to the local Central Office or to G.S.O. in an Area where contributions are short of needs.

In such Areas the local service office is to be supported first.

Can you give a general outline on correct sponsorship? What should a sponsor do and not do?

This was a Table Topic discussion subject. The pamphlet on Sponsorship available from G.S.O. is recommended as a helpful guide in this area.

Does selling tickets to friends of A.A. for A.A. dances, picnics, jamborees, etc. violate Tradition Seven?

Most Delegates felt this did not violate Tradition Seven.

Should a police officer in uniform be allowed to drop in for a cup of coffee in an A.A. clubhouse?

Most Delegates saw no objection to this.

Should Groups, made up of members affiliated with other Groups, receive G.S.O. mailings?

Groups indicate their interest in receiving mail when they fill out the Group Information form. Some "special" Groups listed in our records do not receive mail from G.S.O.

What can be done about a member who brings dope addicts to A.A. meetings? Or about long-time members who want to bar the doors to pill and narcotic addicts?

The former happens in institutions primarily. Suggest reading Bill's article in the February 1958 "Grapevine." A.A.'s primary purpose is helping the alcoholic with his alcoholic problem. The addict may find help in open meetings.

Should a Twelfth Step call be made upon request of a third party?

A show of hands indicated a 2 to 1 reluctance.

Groups in cities where state hospital treatment centers and prison Groups are located may be troubled financially by those released from institutions. They expect financial help from members. What do Groups do about released institutional members who expect financial help from A.A.?

Tell them that A.A. has nothing to offer but sobriety, and provide accurate information about A.A. as well as sponsorship.

Literature

Is it feasible to index the Big Book?

The sense of the Conference was that no index was necessary. It was pointed out that the Big Book deals with ideas. This makes it more difficult to index than "A.A. Comes of Age," which contains factual and historical material and is therefore easier to categorize.

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

Would it be possible to produce a shorter version of the Twelve Concepts?

The Literature Committee is working on this.

Is there a need for a study guide for the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions? Perhaps a pamphlet with pertinent questions might be possible.

Many Delegates felt that such a study guide is needed. Several use such a guide in their Areas, but would like to have one that is Conference-approved. It was proposed that Delegates send sufficient copies of such literature to G.S.O. for review by the Conference Literature Committee, the Literature Committee of the General Service Board and the Staff.

What are the latest contracts concerning royalties on A.A. literature? How many besides Bill and Lois are receiving remuneration from this source? Are payments concluded upon their deaths?

Bill's final book royalty contract with A.A.W.S. was discussed by him at the Joint Finance Committee meeting and a resume of his statement is included in the minutes of the meeting and will so appear in the Final Conference Report. There are no royalties paid on pamphlets.

Is it permissible to make recordings of the Big Book, Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions, and other literature for the blind who do not read Braille?

A.A.W.S. has given permission for such recordings to be made and they are available through libraries for the blind.

Has our Fellowship, by copyright, the exclusive use of the name Alcoholics Anonymous?

The A.A. name cannot be registered as a "trademark" but the Alcoholics Anonymous title of the Big Book gives valid copyright protection.

Can there be a pamphlet about profanity in Groups and from the speaker's platform?

The "Exchange Bulletin" has covered this. The July 1964 "Grapevine" will also have something on this.

Does World Service sell A.A. literature to all outside agencies and interested parties who want to buy?

Yes. We cooperate with anybody who asks for it.

Outside Agencies

How can you get A.A. to cooperate with halfway houses?

This may be difficult until there is full understanding of the needs of these particular organizations. Best results are usually obtained when individual A.A.'s have all the information necessary to be effective in sponsoring an alcoholic in this situation. In addition to having a desire to help, the individual A.A. must be aware of the regulations under which the halfway house operates.

What is the best solution when a Foundation is detrimental to A.A.?

It is felt that lack of communication is the real difficulty, and discussion of problems can help to solve this. It was stressed that A.A.'s primary purpose is the most important thing to keep in mind.

If a group of A.A. members contribute to purchase a halfway house which is later sold, what should be done with the money left over?

This is not an A.A. matter since traditionally halfway houses are incorporated outside of A.A.

P.I.C.

How is A.A.'s "Report to the Public" distributed?

It is distributed to newspapers and other media which have requested that information concerning A.A. be sent to them as it is issued; also to local P.I. Committees and to Delegates.

What tools can we use to reach alcoholics in a wealthy section of the city? How can we obtain appropriate newspaper material?

G.S.O. will review our background editorial material to determine if special material is needed. One Delegate suggested that such individuals might be treated as Loners and so maintain contact with G.S.O.

Traditions

It is healthy to suggest that the Traditions are elastic? Could this suggestion lead to "elastic" violations? Indications are that rapidly changing conditions will lead to a need some time in the future for updating of the Traditions. Can the study of this matter be started now, while we still have Bill, Bernard Smith and Dr. Jack available?

There is considerable difference of opinion. One Delegate noted, in fact, that there are members in his Area who consider the Traditions old, perhaps obsolete. Another Delegate pointed out that A.A. can become stereotyped if we do not allow freedom of interpretation. We should not be too concerned with creed or dogma. As far as updating of the Traditions is concerned, this is a matter of continuing interest to the Board of Trustees. Their objective, however, is to be custodian of the Traditions, rather than to change them. One Delegate noted that they would no longer be Traditions if they were updated.

Does A.A. thinking keep pace with the changing times? If not, should we update our thinking in line with the great numbers of new people coming into A.A. who have not had a great deal of trouble?

There is a good deal of concern about presenting A.A. to such people without changing A.A.'s basic concepts. One Delegate said this matter was being considered in his Area because of interest being created about community responsibility for alcoholics. They will come to A.A. on an agency's recommendation, to find a philosophy that will help them maintain their sobriety. Thus it is important for A.A. members to be knowledgeable about the A.A. program and to be able to discuss the Twelve Steps as a means of maintaining sobriety. Another Delegate said that "updating" could mean diluting the program of A.A. to please outside organizations.

Is the reading of the Twelve Traditions at every Group meeting generally the practice throughout the country?

Eleven Delegates said it was customary in their Areas to read the Traditions at every meeting. In the rest, this is done occasionally.

Is an "advertisement" by the printer on the front cover of literature sold to Groups by a Central Office considered a violation of A.A. Traditions? Such printing might read: Printed courtesy of Blank Press, address and telephone number.

It was felt to be a violation of the Traditions of self-support and non-endorsement.

G.S.O. AND A GROWING FELLOWSHIP

In the past nineteen years, G.S.O. has grown to meet the service needs of a rapidly increasing Fellowship. Since 1945, the number of A.A. Groups in the world has grown from 983 to 10,956. During that same period, the service program has increased steadily until today G.S.O. is concerned with nine different services each developed to meet a specific need.

How efficient has been G.S.O.'s growth? In terms of personnel: In 1945 there was one employee for each 98 Groups. Today there is one employee for each 280 Groups.

During these same years, the G.S.O. budget increased from \$20,000 to \$284,000 for services charged to the Group contribution account. During that same period, cost of living increased 69%.

So, adjusting for this change in dollar value, we find that the cost of services *per Group* actually showed a decrease from \$20.60 to \$15.30.

	Groups	Employees	Groups per Employee	\$ Cost per Group	Living Costs
1945	983	10	98	\$20.60	100
1950	4,052	20	202	22.06	139
1955	6,249	27	230	22.81	148
1960	8,615	31	278	28.25	165
1963	10,956	39	280	25.93	169

To give the movement a clear picture of how G.S.O. funds are spent, a new analysis has been prepared to pick up salaries and overhead (as well as supplies, postage and other direct expenses) in the cost of each of nine services:

Services to regular Groups in U.S. and Can.	22%
Group "Exchange Bulletin"	4%
A.A. in Institutions	1½%
Loners and Internationalists	1½%
World Directory and Records	13%
General Service Conference	13%
Public Information	5½%
Publishing**	18%
Meetings, General Service Board, Other Administration	15%
	100%

**Publishing contributes about 35% of available G.S.O. income; takes 18% from the budget for wrapping, shipping, overhead, salary allocation, etc.

1964 G.S.O. Budget

The budget for 1964 operations of the General Service Office, exclusive of The A.A. Grapevine, is as follows:

ESTIMATED CONTRIBUTIONS, NET INCOME FROM SALES AND OPERATING EXPENSES

	Income	Expenses	Net Income	Net (Deficit)
G.S.O. (Contributions)	\$290,000	\$300,800*	\$	\$(10,800)
A.A. World Services (Publishing)	172,800**	129,500	43,300	
General Service Bd. (General Fund)***		31,700		(31,700)
	<u>\$462,800</u>	<u>\$462,000</u>	<u>\$43,300</u>	<u>\$(42,500)</u>

Estimated Net Income \$800***

* Including cost of General Service Conference\$32,800

** Based upon gross Income from sales (totaling \$283,000) of
 31,300 Books - "Alcoholics Anonymous"
 11,550 Books - "12 Steps & 12 Traditions"
 3,820 Books - "A.A. Comes of Age"
 Averaged-Pamphlets & Miscellaneous

*** Exclusive of Reserve Fund appreciation of.....\$31,500

****Board meetings, P.I.C. Exp., Special projects

Expenses of G.S.O. for 1964 have been budgeted at \$24,600 over the 1963 expenses (a 5½% increase). Although economies effected on printing the World Directory and distribution of the Exchange Bulletin have been taken into consideration, an anticipated substantial increase in new Groups in 1964, increased service to all Groups, an additional day added to the Conference and rising costs of postage, insurance, payroll taxes, etc., make this increase necessary.

Contributions of \$290,000 are expected for 1964, \$19,700 over the 1963 total. The Budget Committee considers this a conservative estimate.

G.S.B. Finance & Budgetary Committee

(Archibald B. Roosevelt, Treasurer, G.S.B.)

Operations of A.A.'s General Services resulted in a deficit of \$3,100 in 1963 as compared with a net income of \$9,560 in 1962. (Exclusive of Reserve Fund appreciation.)

The publishing activities of A. A. World Services, Inc. earned \$39,400. A decrease of \$17,200 over 1962.

Group contributions in 1963 were \$270,275, approximately 5% less than the cost of Office and Conference expenses. The sum of \$14,000 was transferred from the General Fund to the Group Fund to make up this deficit of \$13,810. As against our estimated budgeted expenses, contributions were \$8,960 short. Our total operating expenses (Group, General Fund, Publishing) were 3.2% over the budgeted amount as projected by the Budget Committee.

Book discounts donated and invested income resulted in a net addition to the General Service Board Reserve Fund of \$30,480 for the year 1963.

A.A. Grapevine, Inc., 1964 Budget

Estimated income from subscription and bulk sales \$164,000.00

Estimated expenses 154,900.00

Net income 9,100.00

SUGGESTED SHARE OF 1964 BUDGET

Based on an estimated budget of \$300,800 and on the 1963 membership, the share of each state and province for the year 1964 is apportioned in the following schedule.

U.S.	1963 Membership	State or Province Share	U.S.	1963 Membership	State or Province Share
Alabama.....	1,056	\$ 2,305	Ohio.....	8,147	\$ 17,775
Alaska.....	269	585	Oklahoma.....	1,311	2,860
Arizona.....	1,162	2,535	Oregon.....	1,164	2,540
Arkansas.....	998	2,175	Pennsylvania.....	4,545	9,910
California.....	20,756	45,260	Rhode Island.....	305	665
Colorado.....	1,252	2,730	South Carolina.....	1,007	2,195
Connecticut.....	2,060	4,495	South Dakota.....	734	1,600
Delaware.....	321	700	Tennessee.....	910	1,985
District of Columbia.....	764	1,665	Texas.....	6,971	15,200
Florida.....	4,055	8,845	Utah.....	698	1,520
Georgia.....	1,440	3,140	Vermont.....	275	600
Hawaii.....	294	640	Virginia.....	2,240	4,885
Idaho.....	303	680	Washington.....	2,184	4,765
Illinois.....	9,200	20,075	West Virginia.....	455	990
Indiana.....	2,264	4,940	Wisconsin.....	2,217	4,835
Iowa.....	1,631	3,560	Wyoming.....	285	620
Kansas.....	1,466	3,200	Commonwealth of P.R.....	457	995
Kentucky.....	929	2,025			
Louisiana.....	1,610	3,510	TOTAL for U.S.A.....	122,483	\$267,180
Maine.....	497	1,085	CANADA		
Maryland.....	1,581	3,450	Alberta.....	1,066	2,325
Massachusetts.....	3,832	8,360	British Columbia.....	2,121	4,630
Michigan.....	5,323	11,615	Manitoba.....	1,155	2,520
Minnesota.....	4,371	9,535	New Brunswick.....	484	1,055
Mississippi.....	737	1,610	Newfoundland.....	139	305
Missouri.....	2,511	5,475	Nova Scotia.....	532	1,160
Montana.....	570	1,245	Ontario.....	4,931	10,760
Nebraska.....	634	1,385	Prince Edward Island.....	198	430
Nevada.....	583	1,270	Quebec.....	3,730	8,140
New Hampshire.....	373	815	Saskatchewan.....	1,020	2,225
New Jersey.....	3,031	6,615	Yukon Territory.....	24	50
New Mexico.....	671	1,460	Northwest Territories.....	10	20
New York.....	9,301	20,295			
North Carolina.....	2,246	4,900	TOTAL for CANADA.....	15,410	\$ 33,620
North Dakota.....	487	1,060	TOTAL for U.S.A. & CANADA.....	137,893	\$300,800

COMBINED BALANCE SHEET

The General Service Office and The A. A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1963

	December 31, 1963		December 31, 1962	
	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine	Service Office	A.A. Grapevine
ASSETS				
Cash	\$133,176	\$ 55,575	\$144,885	\$ 42,537
Accounts Receivable	9,986	2,095	7,446	2,189
Inventories	84,500	980	69,400	1,551
Prepaid Expenses	9,628	6,978	5,223	6,776
Furniture and Equipment (net)	1	2,000	1	3,326
RESERVE FUND and CONVENTION GUARANTEE FUND (see below)	291,476		259,426	
Total Assets	<u>528,767</u>	<u>67,628</u>	<u>486,381</u>	<u>56,379</u>
DEDUCT LIABILITIES				
Accounts and Accruals Payable	24,866	2,339	22,840	5,964
Unearned Income	619	64,355	619	59,894
Due General Service Board				11,570
Total Liabilities	<u>25,485</u>	<u>66,694</u>	<u>23,459</u>	<u>77,428</u>
NET WORTH				
Accumulated Income (Deficit):				
Balance, January 1	203,496	(21,050)	200,435	(25,881)
Income for Period (Exhibits B & C)	(3,259)	21,983	9,561	4,831
Collection of Advances to A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	11,570			
Transfer to CONVENTION FUND			(6,500)	
Capital Stock		1		1
RESERVE AND CONVENTION FUNDS	291,476		259,426	
Total Net Worth	<u>503,282</u>	<u>934</u>	<u>462,922</u>	<u>(21,049)</u>
NET WORTH BY FUNCTION				
World Service Office (Note B)	\$ 11,008		\$ 10,815	
Publishing (Note A)	118,839		124,436	
General Fund (Note A)	81,960		68,245	
Reserve and Convention Funds	291,476		259,426	
Total - as above	<u>503,282</u>		<u>462,922</u>	
RESERVE AND CONVENTION FUNDS	Reserve	Convention	Reserve	Convention
Cash (Note C)	\$ 49,936	\$ 8,588	\$ 5,975	\$ 7,514
U.S. Treasury Obligations	214,925		228,477	
Corporate Bonds - U.S.	9,356		9,356	
Mortgage Debentures - Can.		6,500		6,000
Accrued Interest	2,171		2,104	
Totals - At Cost	<u>276,388</u>	<u>15,088</u>	<u>245,912</u>	<u>13,514</u>

() Denotes red figures.

NOTES TO FINANCIAL STATEMENTS: In the attached financial statements of The General Service Office and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., amounts for the Service Office combine the accounts of The General Service Board of A.A., Inc. and of A.A. World Services, Inc. The latter corporation publishes books and pamphlets and pays a portion of the expenses of the General Service Office, while the accounts of the General Service Board are further subdivided into four Funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND, which was established in 1954 by transfer from the General Fund of cash then on deposit in savings accounts, for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve. Its use may be authorized by the Board of Trustees, on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The CONVENTION GUARANTEE FUND, which was established in 1962 to underwrite a possible deficit in receipts from International Convention to be held in Toronto in 1965. To the extent it is not used it is to be refunded to the subscribers.

The GROUP CONTRIBUTION FUND, which was established in 1941 to receive contributions from A.A. Groups and members to be used solely for the expenses of the General Service Office, and, subsequently, the costs of the General Service Conference.

(continued)

INCOME STATEMENT

The General Service Office

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1963

	<u>1963</u>	<u>1962</u>
INCOME		
Sales	\$272,109	\$263,870
Less: Cost of Products Sold	80,478	81,352
Royalties on Books	27,658	26,506
Gross Profit from Sales	<u>163,973</u>	<u>156,012</u>
Contributions	270,275	256,015
<u>Total Income</u>	<u>434,248</u>	<u>412,027</u>
EXPENSES		
Salaries	205,728	181,054
Rent	30,282	30,089
Service Office Printing	36,306	33,258
Shipping and Mailing	30,797	27,865
Other Office Expenses	36,901	37,652
Insurance and Taxes	16,011	14,760
Professional Services, Gifts	15,263	13,374
Board, Committee, Staff Meetings	11,628	7,444
Writing, Research, Bedford Hills	12,778	12,293
P.I.C., Travel	5,193	5,455
General Service Conference	30,348	31,815
Foreign Literature Aid	3,988	4,510
Film Strip and Display Boards	2,284	2,897
<u>Total Expense</u>	<u>437,507</u>	<u>402,466</u>
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE)	<u>(3,259)</u>	<u>9,561</u>
NET INCOME (EXPENSE) BY FUNCTION		
World Service Office	(\$ 13,807)	(\$ 15,983)
Publishing	39,403	56,625
General Fund	(28,855)	(31,081)
<u>Total - as above</u>	<u>(3,259)</u>	<u>9,561</u>

	<u>1963</u>		<u>1962</u>	
RESERVE AND CONVENTION FUND CHANGES	<u>Reserve</u>	<u>Convention</u>	<u>Reserve</u>	<u>Convention</u>
Balance, January 1	\$245,912	\$ 13,514	\$218,896	
Book Discounts Donated	19,832		18,706	
Subscriptions		1,300		\$ 13,485
Investment Income (net)	10,644	274	8,310	29
Balance, December 31	<u>276,388</u>	<u>15,088</u>	<u>245,912</u>	<u>13,514</u>

() Denotes red figures.

(continued from foot of Exhibit A)

The GENERAL FUND, which is comprised of those assets not included in either of the other Funds and which may be used for any of the purposes for which the corporation was formed.

In the attached statements the net worth and net operating results for the year of A.A. World Services, Inc. are referred to as Publishing, of the Group Contribution Fund as World Service Office, of the Convention Guarantee Fund as Convention Fund, and of the Reserve Fund and General Fund by those names.

NOTE A - After transfers of \$45,000 in 1963 and \$65,000 in 1962 from Publishing to General Fund.

NOTE B - Advances of \$14,000 in 1963 and \$16,000 in 1962 were made by the General Fund to the Group Contribution Fund to make up deficits in Group contributions in those years. Advances to the Group Contribution Fund in these and prior years remaining unpaid at December 31, 1963 totaled \$96,765.

NOTE C - Included in cash of the Convention Fund was U.S. currency of \$6,744 in 1963 and \$6,513 in 1962, the remaining assets being in Canadian currency stated at par in these statements.

INCOME STATEMENT

The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1963

	<u>1963</u>	<u>1962</u>
INCOME		
Subscriptions, Sales and Interest	<u>\$163,430</u>	<u>\$148,313</u>
EDITORIAL AND PRINTING COSTS		
Salaries	25,493	25,486
Severance Pay	1,451	4,854
Printing	37,745	35,074
Mailing	15,388	13,483
Rent	5,220	5,235
Telephone	1,226	1,451
Office Supplies and Expense	1,536	1,399
Office Cleaning	514	500
Total	<u>88,573</u>	<u>87,482</u>
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries	24,813	26,952
Severance Pay		2,850
Stationery and Supplies	1,657	1,958
Rent	5,220	5,235
Telephone	872	880
Office Expense	1,945	1,561
Bad Debts	223	404
Selling Expense	3,611	3,780
Postage	3,110	2,907
Office Cleaning	514	500
Total	<u>41,965</u>	<u>47,027</u>
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Insurance	2,363	2,492
Legal and Accounting	2,500	1,900
Taxes	4,113	3,256
Meetings	498	575
New Equipment and Depreciation	1,435	750
Total	<u>10,909</u>	<u>8,973</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>141,447</u>	<u>143,482</u>
NET INCOME	<u>21,983</u>	<u>4,831</u>

1963 GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS

U.S.	# Gps. Reported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. Per Capita
Alabama	57	33	58%	\$ 2,701.78	1,056	\$ 2.56
Alaska	32	13	41	1,009.50	269	3.75-1
Arizona	89	43	49	2,697.00	1,162	2.32
Arkansas	55	33	60	1,623.50	998	1.63
California	1,008	573	57	36,023.96	20,756	1.74
Colorado	60	41	69	2,842.20	1,252	2.27
Connecticut	106	55	52	4,566.35	2,060	2.22
Delaware	14	12	86	831.35	321	2.59
Dist. of Columbia	31	18	58	1,551.00	764	2.03
Florida	238	139	59	11,734.35	4,055	2.89
Georgia	97	53	55	2,385.30	1,440	1.66
Hawaii	31	17	55	673.50	294	2.29
Idaho	26	15	58	715.15	303	2.36
Illinois	482	445	92	7,958.01	9,200	.87
Indiana	165	86	52	4,901.26	2,264	2.17
Iowa	80	42	53	4,144.80	1,631	2.54
Kansas	85	66	78	3,117.63	1,466	2.13
Kentucky	78	49	63	3,278.58	929	3.53
Louisiana	90	44	49	2,523.90	1,610	1.57
Maine	48	26	54	1,007.00	497	2.03
Maryland	104	62	60	3,625.50	1,581	2.28
Massachusetts	185	96	52	6,106.56	3,832	1.59
Michigan	321	176	55	12,331.57	5,323	2.32
Minnesota	245	181	74	7,079.29	4,371	1.62
Mississippi	35	20	57	1,522.00	737	2.07
Missouri	138	70	51	4,064.43	2,511	1.62
Montana	58	24	42	770.70	570	1.35
Nebraska	59	46	78	2,064.39	634	3.26
Nevada	40	24	60	1,177.00	583	2.02
New Hampshire	27	13	49	1,026.50	373	2.75
New Jersey	228	138	61	7,567.27	3,031	2.50
New Mexico	46	29	63	1,726.12	671	2.57
New York	462	322	70	22,029.38	9,301	2.37
North Carolina	160	91	57	3,927.13	2,246	1.75
North Dakota	38	18	48	557.00	487	1.14
Ohio	425	223	53	12,424.04	8,147	1.53
Oklahoma	74	59	80	4,720.70	1,311	3.60-2nd
Oregon	97	62	64	2,462.29	1,164	2.12
Pennsylvania	278	165	60	11,040.11	4,545	2.43
Rhode Island	27	19	71	1,149.65	305	3.77-2nd
South Carolina	67	45	67	1,991.21	1,007	1.98
South Dakota	49	32	65	1,498.00	734	2.04
Tennessee	59	33	56	2,159.75	910	2.37
Texas	331	185	56	12,596.45	6,971	1.81
Utah	54	24	45	992.50	698	1.42
Vermont	25	16	64	617.00	275	2.24
Virginia	122	66	54	4,902.75	2,240	2.19
Washington	163	92	57	5,488.48	2,184	2.51
West Virginia	33	16	49	946.00	455	2.08
Wisconsin	162	103	64	4,597.56	2,217	2.07
Wyoming	27	19	71	872.00	285	3.06
Commonwealth of P.R.	22	11	50	488.50	457	1.07
TOTAL for U.S.	7,033	4,283	61%	\$240,837.95	122,483	\$ 1.97

CANADA	# Gps. Reported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. Per Capita
Alberta	109	59	54%	\$ 3,424.06	1,066	\$ 3.21
Atlantic Provinces						
New Brunswick	30	17	57	528.11	484	1.09
Newfoundland	10	7	70	256.30	139	1.84
Nova Scotia	47	25	53	1,028.09	532	1.83
Prince Edward Island	11	5	46	316.00	198	1.60
British Columbia	161	81	50	4,942.85	2,121	2.33
Manitoba	57	31	55	1,825.78	1,155	1.58
N.W. Territories	3	2	67	35.55	10	3.56
Ontario	346	196	57	8,572.34	4,931	1.74
Quebec	210	71	34	1,668.73	3,730	.45
Saskatchewan	88	53	60	2,310.70	1,020	2.17
Yukon Territory	3	1	34	59.32	24	2.47
TOTAL for CANADA	1,075	548	51%	\$ 24,967.83	15,410	\$ 1.62
TOTAL for U.S. and CANADA	8,108	4,831	60%	\$265,805.78	137,893	\$ 1.93

FOREIGN

Foreign	1,690			\$ 2,844.05	32,071	
Lone Members*					720	
World Hello				57.38		
Internationalists				781.85	300	
International Doctors				200.00		
Hospital Groups	514			931.20	11,417	
Prison Groups	644			161.92	27,753	
GRAND TOTAL	10,956			\$270,782.18	209,434	

*Contributions and membership of Lone Members are included in State Province and Foreign totals

GROUP CONTRIBUTIONS COMPARISON --- 1962-63

	# Gps. Reported	# Gps. Contrib.	% of Gps. Contrib.	Amount of Contrib.	Member- ship	Contrib's. Per Capita
U.S.A. 1963	7,033	4,283	61%	\$240,837.95	122,483	\$ 1.97
U.S.A. 1962	6,586	3,957	60	228,945.49	117,953	1.94
Increase (Decrease)	447	326	1%	\$ 11,892.46	4,530	\$.03
Canada 1963	1,075	548	51%	\$ 24,967.83	15,410	\$ 1.62
Canada 1962	946	519	55	22,669.21	13,093	1.73
Increase (Decrease)	129	29	(4%)	\$ 2,298.62	2,317	\$ (.11)
U.S.A. & Canada '63	8,108	4,831	60%	\$265,805.78	137,893	\$ 1.93
U.S.A. & Canada '62	7,532	4,476	60	251,614.70	131,046	1.92
Increase (Decrease)	576	355	-0-%	\$ 14,191.08	6,847	\$.01

TORONTO CONVENTION COMMITTEE REPORT

The Convention Committee met with the Convention Advisory Committee and representatives of the Host Committee during the the 1964 Conference.

"Policies and Procedures for the 30th Anniversary International Convention" were reviewed. In accordance with approved procedures, Convention plans will be in the hands of the following committees:

1. *1965 Convention Committee* of the General Service Board comprises the Chairman of General Services, the Chairman of the Public Information Committee of the General Service Board, and the Staff Member serving as Conference Secretary. This committee is responsible to the Board of Trustees and enjoys the help of the *Convention Advisory Committee* and the *Convention Host Committee*. It has the responsibility of programming, meeting facilities, housing and feeding, registration, public relations, sale of literature, decorations and signs, and all arrangements with the Convention Bureau.
2. *The Convention Advisory Committee* comprises the chairman, all current and past Ontario Delegates, current Delegates from other Canadian provinces, eighteen U. S. Delegates (twenty-one in 1965). This committee serves in an advisory capacity on matters of policy referred to it by the Convention Committee. The Canadian Delegates on the Advisory Committee have been responsible for the securing of the Guarantee Fund. Current Canadian Delegates of all provinces will be responsible for Advance Registration.
3. *The Convention Host Committee* is a local committee. It may have as many subcommittees as deemed necessary and is responsible to the chairman of the Convention Committee.

The following reports were made by Whit Hillmer, Al Boyle, Tom Turner, Jim Lumley, Cliff Morris and Bob Roy:

Financial

From the experience of the past International Conventions a realistic figure had to be developed in the Guarantee Fund — this was \$13,000: The Board of Trustees guaranteed half of this — \$6,500 advance was needed. G.S.O. would accept 50% of any deficit that might occur. The question was how this money would be raised in Canada and so a letter was sent out to the Groups in Canada and they were asked if they would like to contribute \$100 to the General Fund. There was a great response and the Canadian share exceeds \$8,000. The Convention, if successful, will return money of Guarantee Fund to donors.

Publicity & Public Information

Banners will be at every convention in Canada announcing the '65 Convention. The Canadian press has been reached with a release on advance registrations. Publicity will also appear in the "Exchange Bulletin" and the "Grapevine."

Advance Registration

A letter (Convention Call) was mailed out to all Canadian Groups — to all the G.S.R.'s and the member receiving Group mail. This was read at the Group and followed by one or two talks which were enclosed. (These talks were in French also.) A Gold Wallet Card is being issued to each advance registrant.

French-Speaking Members

Quebec has formed a Provincial Committee under the chairmanship of ex-Delegate Rollie Davidson — there are six members now but more will be added as the need develops. Within the last two weeks there have been 30-35 registrations. A system has been developed that when a registration is received from a Group another registration form is sent out immediately to eliminate unnecessary correspondence.

The "Exchange Bulletin" is translated into French and each month an article is carried pertaining to the Convention. Thought

is being given to having a French panel and French speakers at the Convention.

Host Committee

This committee consists of the chairman of the Convention plus the chairmen of the 13 subcommittees of the Host Committee. Although all subcommittees are not actually functioning at this time the members attend all other meetings so they will be completely informed on all activities.

Regular Registration

The Committee recommended February 1, 1965 as the starting date for general registration and housing.

Al-Anon Participation

It was the sense of the meeting that Al-Anon participate in some way in the 1965 A.A. Convention, the actual programming to be left to the Convention Committee. This developed out of discussion that Al-Anon requested a place on the program to get across to the people just what Al-Anon is and what it does. They believe that with better understanding of this organization more people may receive assistance and their Groups will grow.

The Committee asks for Conference guidance on the type of participation Al-Anon should have at the 1965 Convention.

Ex-Delegates

It was suggested that perhaps a different color badge might be given to them at the Convention or a luncheon might be arranged during the Convention.

The Committee asked for Conference guidance on the type of arrangements which might be made for the ex-Delegates at the 1965 Convention.

POLICY COMMITTEE

The Committee held three sessions during the 1964 General Service Conference.

The Committee:

Approves the idea that Conference committees be enlarged from six to eight members.

Approves the proposal that Conference committees select a co-chairman from first-year Delegates to become chairman the second year.

Approves the proposal that all out-going Conference committee members serve in an ex-officio capacity for a full year after their terms are concluded.

Approves the proposal that Areas which volunteered on an experimental basis will have their G.S.R.'s receive G.S.O. mailings exclusively.

Approves the preparation of a smaller edition of the "Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions," to be introduced at the 30th Anniversary Convention in 1965, to be sold at \$3.00 or more.

Suggests that time allotted for committee work be held to at least the same level as this year and, if possible, increased in 1965.

Recommends that procedures for selecting Conference committees be studied during the forthcoming year.

Recommends that communications between Conference committee members be increased when feasible and desirable, to enhance the work of the standing committees.

• • • • •

Heartily approves the pattern of G.S.O. employee compensation endorsed by the Conference, following the discussion of Staff salaries.

LITERATURE

The Conference Literature Committee recommends that the words, "This is A.A. General Service Conference-approved literature," be used under the seal on all Conference-approved literature, and that reprints carry the wording, "This material has been reprinted with the approval of the A.A. General Service Conference."

The current literature order form was reviewed and it was the sense of the meeting that the reference to the foreign literature order blanks be printed in bold type and underlined. On the second page the "Note" referring to institutional packages, pamphlets, Braille editions of the Big Book and translations should be boxed in with a bold line. It was the sense of the meeting that the current literature order blank fills the present needs except for the above recommended changes.

There was discussion as to whether there was a need for a new pamphlet for newcomers, which would be more specific as to the first drink, the 24 Hour Plan, etc. It was the sense of the meeting that a decision should be deferred for further discussion until a review of all current literature can be made by members of the committee.

The committee recommends preparation of a pamphlet for A.A. in hospitals similar to the new "A.A. in Prisons" pamphlet, and that such a pamphlet be suitable for use in tubercular hospitals.

All members of the Literature Committee will be sent a copy of all pamphlets for review in terms of the following questions: "Do we have enough literature? Do we have too much literature? What should we do to promote sale of literature?" Comments are to be sent to the Secretary of the Literature Committee by June 15.

The committee agreed to be a "working committee" during the Conference year, April 1964 to April 1965. Members will share correspondence and ideas, and will hope to deliver a complete analysis of their functions and problems for the consideration of the 1965 General Service Conference Literature Committee. This was a unanimous decision of all members. The Secretary of the committee will receive copies of correspondence for sharing with the General Service Board Literature Committee. Our primary function is to assist the Literature Committee of the Board so as to provide the best possible literature for A.A. Thus we invite all comments, critical or complimentary, at all times.

There was discussion regarding pamphlets and literature other than that which is Conference-approved being displayed or sold at area and state conferences. It was the sense of the meeting that we have no authority in this area. It is to be noted that all Conference-approved literature should be made available at A.A. get-togethers.

The Literature Committee is looking forward to reviewing the "Twelve Concepts of Service" in short form in the very near future.

There was discussion as to whether review of tapes and films available from G.S.O. should be the responsibility of the Literature Committee. It was the sense of the meeting that the possibility of a relationship between the Literature Committee and the Tape Committee be referred to the General Service Board for its consideration. The Conference Literature Committee felt it would not be practical for members to participate in tape or film review.

There was discussion that thought be given to the idea of having a two-day session of the combined Literature Committees at some future time.

The Committee will also consider need for a pamphlet directed specifically to the social worker.

REPORT AND CHARTER

The committee met and selected a chairman from Panel 13 and a co-chairman from Panel 14.

The committee welcomed the opportunity to review a draft of the Final Conference Report. Any suggestions, corrections or comments they have will be forwarded to the Conference Secretary no later than May 11, 1964.

FINANCE

(G. S. B. and G. S. C. Committees)

The Conference Committee on Finances, meeting jointly with members of the General Service Board Committee on Budget and Finance;

1. Accepted the report of the Treasurer of the General Service Board, shown on another page of the Final Report of the Conference.
2. Agreed with the recommendation of G.S.O.'s independent accountant that General Service Agencies should not adopt a fiscal year.
3. Recommended that the present pattern of book discounts (whereby the Groups have waived a portion of their discount to permit creation of an adequate Reserve Fund) be deferred for such action as may be taken by the 1965 Conference.
4. Recommended exploration of a pension program for G.S.O. employees with possible linkage to income from book discount waivers.
5. Accepted the 1964 General Service budget, as presented by the General Manager of G.S.O.
6. Approved an agreement between Bill W., co-founder, and A.A. World Services, Inc., covering royalties derived from Bill's writings.

Under the terms of the contract, a royalty of 15 per cent is paid to Bill, except that no royalties are paid on "overseas editions." Royalties are to be paid to Bill and Lois, his wife, during their lifetimes; following the deaths of Bill and Lois, royalties revert in shares of royalties to living heirs. These shares revert to A.A.W.S. upon the deaths of the beneficiaries. Not more than 20 per cent may be bequeathed to any heir under the age of 40 years as of the date of the agreement between Bill and A.A.W.S. (April 29, 1963). The contract provides protection of royalties against "cheap books" and protection of A.A.W.S. and Bill against fluctuations in general economic conditions. A.A.W.S. retains the right of "first refusal" on any future literary works of Bill's.

7. Deferred action on extending the scope of the Monthly Sharing Plan, after noting the encouraging results in the six test Areas during the first quarter of 1964. (Contributions up 60%; participating Groups up 33%.)

ADMISSIONS

The committee reviewed a request from the State Committee of Indiana, presented by the Indiana Delegate, for an additional Delegate. It was the feeling of the committee that this request should be tabled for the time being, with the suggestion that more use be made of the State Committee and of larger A.A. gatherings.

The committee also reviewed the request for an additional Delegate from Ontario. This Delegate would cover the North-western Area of the province. The committee noted the great mileage to be covered, but felt the request should be tabled until additional growth might warrant filling the request. The 1800-square-mile Area involves 22 Groups and close to 300 members. It was further suggested that the next Delegate from northern Ontario be from this section, helping to build up Groups and services in that Area.

The committee reviewed the request from the Assembly of the Atlantic Provinces that a second Delegate be admitted to the Conference. The presentation was made by the present Delegate. On the basis of geography, communications and growth, the committee unanimously recommends that this request be granted; the current Panel 14 Delegate, serving as the Delegate for the New Brunswick-Prince Edward Island Area, and a Panel 15 Delegate, serving Nova Scotia and Newfoundland, to be seated at the 1965 Conference.

OUTSIDE AGENCIES

The Committee recommends:

1. That the statement prepared by the Public Information Committee, defining "A.A.'s Position in the Field of Alcoholism" (See page 16) be accepted by the Conference.
2. That G.S.O. put into effect, in cases involving possible misunderstanding of A.A.'s relationship to retreats, a procedure similar to that followed in cases of anonymity breaks.

(Persons believed to be responsible for creating an erroneous impression that A.A. as a Society sponsors retreats should be advised that this is not the case and their attention should be directed to the section, "Questions and Answers on Retreats," in the brochure entitled "Cooperation but not Affiliation.")

Copies of such communications should be sent to the Area Delegates involved.)

3. That G.S.O. correspondence concerning outside organizations and Traditions be shared with the Area Delegate.
4. That Delegates be encouraged to establish and maintain communications with directors of state-supported alcoholism agencies in their Areas.

(Addresses are available from G.S.O.)

TRUSTEES

The committee met in joint session with the Nominating Committee of the General Service Board and moved the adoption of the report of the Nominating Committee of the General Service Board and accepts the following nominees as Trustees and Officers of the General Service Board:

CLASS A TRUSTEES

Leonard Harrison
Austin MacCormick
Hon. John Murtagh
John L. Norris, M.D.
Archibald Roosevelt
Bernard Smith
Harry M. Tiebout, M.D.
Prof. Harrison Trice
Ivan Underwood
(Vacancy)

CLASS B TRUSTEES

David Bancroft
Mary Bernson
Don Goddard
Eugene Kelley
Roy Scovil
Tom Sharpe
Murray Whitsett
Jim Masterson
Bruce Mansfield

OFFICERS

Chairman — Dr. John Norris
1st Vice-Chairman — Bernard Smith
2nd Vice-Chairman — Eugene Kelley
Treasurer — Archibald Roosevelt
Secretary — Murray Whitsett

The committee recommends the adoption and acceptance of the following nominees as Class B Trustees of the General Service Board of A.A.:

D. Bruce Mansfield and Murray Whitsett

The committee recommends that the electoral procedure followed in 1963 and 1964 be followed for future elections of Class B Regional Trustees in the United States.

It was suggested that the Delegates search their Areas and submit to the General Service Board possible candidates for the position of a Class A Trustee. They would submit a summary and these would be placed in the files for future reference.

It was also suggested that, in considering such candidates the fields of professional and industrial people be given special attention.

AGENDA

The Agenda Committee recommends:

1. That the 1965 Conference cover a six-day period.
2. That the "Area Delegate Only" meeting be held on the third evening of the 1965 Conference.
3. That the responsibilities and functions of Conference Committees be explained thoroughly, prior to the selection of committeemen, at future Conferences.
4. That all members of the committee receive copies of all correspondence on agenda matters in which G.S.O. Staff Members and committee members are involved.
5. That committee members be informed of the action taken on their recommendations to the Policy Committee.
6. That committee members be notified of the dates of all General Service Board meetings and G.S.B. Policy Committee meetings so that suggestions may be forwarded in time to assure proper consideration and action prior to the 1965 Conference.
7. That committee members review background material on previous Conferences' actions, as a guide in preparing recommendations for the 1965 Conference agenda.
8. That consideration be given to scheduling panels on "Attraction versus Promotion" or on "Affiliation versus Cooperation."
9. That a "Sharing Session" involving Delegates and the G.S.O. Staff be scheduled in 1965, and that the possibility of joint meetings of such Conference committees as "Agenda" and "Policy" be considered.
10. That consideration be given to the possibility of permitting ex-Delegates to attend future Conferences at their own expense as spectators.
11. That consideration be given to the possibility of scheduling a workshop session on the functions of Conference Committees.

GRAPEVINE

The Committee recommends that:

1. The Board of Directors of the Grapevine and the General Service Board explore the possibilities of using Grapevine material in a French edition of the magazine.
2. That no legal action be taken at this time in connection with the use of copyright "Grapevine" material by "The Older Member Press."
3. That all Grapevine committee members henceforth be kept informed during the year on all Grapevine matters of Conference importance.
4. That the Grapevine Committee be an active working part of the Grapevine effort and that the co-chairman of the committee report on behalf of the Area Delegates in the course of the presentation on the Grapevine at the 1965 Conference.

1964 CONFERENCE MEMBERS

(Trustees, A.A.W.S. Directors, G.S.O. & Grapevine Staffs)

Bill Wilson — Co-founder

G.S.B. TRUSTEES

NONALCOHOLIC

Dr. John L. Norris (Chairman)
Associate Medical Director
Eastman Kodak Company
Rochester, New York

Leonard V. Harrison
Box 383
Old Lyme, Connecticut

Austin H. MacCormick
Osborne Association
114 East 30 Street
New York, New York 10016

Hon. John Murtagh
Administrative Judge
Criminal Court of the City of
New York
100 Center Street
New York, New York 10013

Archibald B. Roosevelt
(Treasurer)
200 East 66 Street
New York, New York 10021

Bernard B. Smith
(Vice-Chairman)
460 Park Avenue
New York, New York 10022

Dr. Harry M. Tiebout
215 Milbank Avenue
Greenwich, Connecticut

Prof. Harrison M. Trice
School of Industrial Labor Relations
Cornell University
Ithaca, New York

L. Ivan Underwood
Purchase Lane
Rye, New York

ALCOHOLIC

Allan E. Bachman
(2nd Vice-Chairman)
37 Ocean Drive, North
Stamford, Connecticut

David Bancroft
755 Gratton Street
Ville St. Laurent
Montreal, Quebec, Canada

Mary Bernson
428 Quaker Road
Chappaqua, New York

Don Goddard
Choate Lane
Pleasantville, New York

Eugene S. Kelley
(Secretary)
Linde Company
270 Park Avenue
New York, New York 10017

James Masterson
2525 Landwood Way
Carmichael, California

Roy Scovil
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Four Observers from
the Grapevine
Editorial Board

TRUSTEES OF THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

April 1964

Nonalcoholic Trustees (Class A)

JOHN L. NORRIS, M.D. ... is Chairman of the General Service Board and the Service Conference. He was elected to the Board in January, 1951. "Dr. Jack" is Associate Medical Director of the Eastman Kodak Company in Rochester, N.Y. ... Chairman of the Governor's Committee on Alcoholism ... President of the Industrial Medicine Association. As his record in and out of A.A. suggests he has contributed much to the understanding and rehabilitation of alcoholics.

LEONARD V. HARRISON ... first came on the Board in 1941 and, with the exception of his resignation from October, 1950 to January, 1953, has been continually active in A.A. affairs. He served as Chairman of the General Service Board from April, 1956 to April, 1961. For many years he served as Director of Public Affairs of the Community Service Society in New York City, but is now retired and living in Old Lyme, Connecticut.

AUSTIN H. MacCORMICK ... Elected to the General Service Board in April, 1961. An early friend of A.A., he had served on the Board previously from October, 1949 to April, 1951. He left in 1951 to become a Professor of Criminology at the University of California in Berkeley, and on his retirement in 1960, returned to New York as Executive Director of the Osborne Association, Inc. He is a Director of the A.A. Grapevine and a member of the Editorial Board.

JOHN M. MURTAGH ... is the Administrative Judge of the Criminal Court of New York, a new court with 78 judges replacing Magistrates' Courts and Court of Special Sessions. Previously, he had been Chief Justice of the Court of Special Sessions, Chief City Magistrate, and Commissioner of Investigation of New York. He is married and the father of four children. The Judge has long been a good friend of A.A.

ARCHIBALD B. ROOSEVELT (Treasurer of the General Service Board and Chairman of the Board's Finance and Budgetary Committee) ... was elected to the General Service Board in January, 1953. He is a partner in the investment firm of Roosevelt & Cross, Inc., and is well known for his interest in philanthropic affairs.

BERNARD B. SMITH ... was elected to the General Service Board in June, 1944 and has been very active, serving as Chairman of the General Service Board and General Service Conference from January, 1951 to April, 1956. He is an attorney and author and has made an outstanding contribution in the cause of Anglo-American understanding. In October, 1957 he received a decoration, Honorary Commander of the Order of the British Empire from the hands of Her Majesty, Queen Elizabeth, on her visit to the United States.

HARRY M. TIEBOUT, M.D. ... was elected to the Board in April, 1957. He was the first psychiatrist to recognize the work of Alcoholics Anonymous and to use A.A. principles in his own practice. In the early days when A.A. was little known, he was instrumental in having Bill W. speak before the Neurology and Psychiatry section of the Medical Society of the State of New York, and the American Psychiatric Association. He has written many inspiring articles, among them, "The Ego Factors in the Surrender of Alcoholism."

HARRISON M. TRICE, Ph.D. ... was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1957 and has served there, and as a member of the Literature Committee, with great enthusiasm. He is a professor in the School of Industrial and Labor Relations at Cornell University. He has been a frequent contributor to professional journals, and a consultant to various study groups and to private companies on the subject of alcoholism.

L. IVAN UNDERWOOD ... was elected to the Board in January, 1955. He heads up the export activities of Republic Steel Corporation, traveling a great deal and visiting A.A. overseas. He was Chairman of the General Service Board Literature Committee in 1962 and is presently serving in that capacity.

A.A. Trustees (Class B)

ALLAN BACHMAN... was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1960 and has served as Second Vice Chairman of the Board; also, as Chairman of the Public Information Committee of the General Service Board. He has also served as Chairman of the General Service Conference Study Committee on Relations with Outside Agencies. He also serves as a Director of A.A. World Services, Inc. He joined A.A. in 1947 and is still an active member of the Stamford, Connecticut Group. He served as President of the New York Intergroup Steering Committee from June, 1956 to July, 1957. Professionally, he serves as Executive Vice President of the National Better Business Bureau and is the author of several books and a number of articles on business subjects for business and trade magazines.

DAVID M. BANCROFT ... was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1961. He was nominated by the A.A. groups in Quebec, Canada. He has had 19 years of continuous sobriety in A.A. and was the first Delegate to the General Service Conference from the Province of Quebec. He introduced A.A. to Montreal and subsequently to all of the Province of Quebec. He has his own business, a general accounting service.

MARY BERNSON ... Elected to the Board, January 1962. She has been an active member of the Chappaqua, New York Group since March 1954. She has been a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board since March 1961. Mary is a practicing lawyer in Chappaqua and formerly practiced law in New York City.

DON GODDARD ... Elected to the General Service Board in October 1961. He served as editor of "The A.A. Grapevine" from 1955 to 1957 and is currently a director of the A.A. Grapevine and a member of the Editorial Board. He joined A.A. in March 1953 and is an active member of the Chappaqua, New York Group. Associated with one of the major broadcasting networks, Don has won two Peabody Awards for news presentation, one for a televised story of A.A.

EUGENE S. KELLEY ... was elected to the Board in April, 1963. He is also a Director of Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. He has served on the Finance Committee of the General Service Board for three years. Has been an active member of the Manhattan Group of New York City since March, 1942. He has served as President of New York Intergroup Association Steering Committee. He has cooperated with the Medical Director of a large corporation in the formation of a policy and plan for the rehabilitation of their alcoholic employees. In non-A.A. life, he has been employed in industrial sales - with the same company for 42 years.

JAMES MASTERSON ... was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1963, following nomination at electoral session of the General Service Conference where he was California's candidate for the Pacific Region. Has had over 12 years of continuous sobriety. Continuous activity in Northern California Conference Committee, serving his area as Alternate Delegate and Delegate. Is Motor Vehicle Representative and License Examiner for the Department of Motor Vehicles, Sacramento.

ROY SCOVIL ... was elected to the General Service Board in April, 1963, following nomination at electoral session of General Service Conference where he was Oklahoma's candidate for the Southwest Region. He has had 20 years of sobriety and did much of the early A.A. pioneering in Oklahoma. He was his state's first Delegate to the General Service Conference. Owns his own business dealing in builders specialties and hardware in Oklahoma City.

THOMAS A. SHARPE ... was elected to the Board in April, 1961. He was nominated by the A.A. Groups in Florida. He has had 20 years of continuous sobriety in A.A. and was the first Florida A.A. member. He was also the North Florida Delegate to the General Service Conference in 1951 and 1952. He operates his own business, that of a manufacturer's agent.

1964 CONFERENCE AREA DELEGATES

STATE	PANEL	STATE	PANEL
ALABAMA & N.W. FLORIDA	(13) <i>Josephine Dix</i> , 115 S. Conception St., Mobile	MICHIGAN	(13) S.E. — <i>Edith Myers</i> , 14866 Santa Rosa, Detroit
ALASKA	(14) <i>Claude Millsap</i> , P. O. Box 1405, Juneau		(13) Central — <i>Fred E. Scott</i> , 617 Eastlawn Drive, Apt. #101, Midland
ARIZONA	(14) <i>Leo Rayburn</i> , 4619 North 54 Avenue, Phoenix		(14) Western — <i>Edwin Laubenthal</i> , 933 Kenneth, S.W., Grand Rapids
ARKANSAS	(13) * <i>Wade Lee</i> , P.O. Box 873, Blytheville	MINNESOTA	(14) *Northern — <i>Donald Formo</i> , 127 E. Summit, Fergus Falls
CALIFORNIA	(13) So. Calif. — <i>Clyde Davis</i> , 126 S. Mansfield Ave., Los Angeles 36		(13) Southern — <i>G.J. (Joe) Ward</i> , 150 West Fourth St., St. Paul 2
	(13) No. Coastal — <i>Bill Garrison</i> , 414 28th Street, Apt. #1, San Francisco 14	MISSISSIPPI	(14) <i>Bish Mathis</i> , P.O. Drawer "D", Pass Christian
	(14) No. Interior — <i>H.K. (Rickey) Schreiber</i> , Box 342, Central Valley	MISSOURI	(13) Eastern — <i>Al H. Sanning</i> , Route #3, Jefferson City
	(14) San Diego — <i>Frank Surman</i> , 4475 Granger Street, San Diego 7		(13) Western — <i>Ken Sperry</i> , 432 West 35 Street, Kansas City
	(14) Southern Coastal — <i>Tom M. Allen</i> , 25532 Pacific Ave., San Bernardino	MONTANA	(14) <i>Judy Machler</i> , Box 88, Lewistown
COLORADO	(13) <i>Floyd Pleasant</i> , Box 246, Craig	NEBRASKA	(14) <i>Don C. Marquard</i> , 640 East Memorial Drive, Grand Island
CONNECTICUT	(13) <i>Frank Jackman</i> , 32 Morris Avenue, Bristol	NEVADA	(13) <i>Kathryn Appelt</i> , 1603 Hastings Ave., Las Vegas
DELAWARE	(14) <i>Richard D. Boyce</i> , Whispering Pines Trailer Court, Dover	NEW HAMPSHIRE	(14) <i>Doris Gumsey</i> , 678 Main Street, Keene
D. C.	(13) <i>C.W. (Buck) Doyle</i> , 5128 Tenth Road No., Arlington, Virginia	NEW JERSEY	(13) Northern — <i>William H. Lyon</i> , 101 First Ave., Belmar
FLORIDA	(13) Northern — <i>Hartwell (Randy) Randall</i> , 281 White St., Daytona Beach		(14) Southern — <i>Ruth L. Day</i> , 739 Park Ave., Collingswood
	(13) Southern — <i>Robert G. Ryder</i> , 3500 So. County Rd., Palm Beach	NEW MEXICO	(14) <i>Darrell McCleskey</i> , P.O. Box 880, Los Alamos
GEORGIA	(14) <i>Heflin Daniel</i> , 188 Temple Avenue, Newnan	NEW YORK	(13) Central — <i>Jane Kenny</i> , 29 Lilac Drive Apt. #1, Rochester 20
HAWAII	(13) <i>Ben Stoddard</i> , 53-103 Kamehameha Highway, Punaluu, Oahu		(14) Mohawk-Hudson-Berkshire — <i>Frank Hogan</i> , 1541 Barclay Place, Schenectady
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	(14) Downstate — <i>R. Bruce Wight</i> , 204 North West Street, Waukegan	NORTH CAROLINA	(13) <i>Mack Franks</i> , 170 Palmer St., Franklin
	(13) Chicago — <i>Paul Martin</i> , 577 Sydney Street, Glen Ellyn	NORTH DAKOTA	(14) <i>Gordon LaMont</i> , 1513 N. Third Street, Fargo
INDIANA	(13) <i>Bill Goen</i> , Box 42, Salem	OHIO	(13) Central & S.E. — <i>Ivan M. Roberts</i> , 263 Bachmann Ave., Newark
IOWA	(13) <i>Ralph Canty</i> , 406 North Maple Avenue, New Hampton		(13) N. E. — <i>George Mills</i> , 1057 Sylvan Avenue, Lakewood 7
KANSAS	(14) <i>F. Sharon Foster</i> , Box 46, Ellsworth		(14) N. W. Ohio & S. E. Mich. — * <i>Elmer Larson</i> , 104 S. Lynn Street, Bryan, Ohio
KENTUCKY	(14) <i>Hugh Alderson</i> , 1744 Harrison St., Paducah		(14) S.W. — <i>Harold Stump</i> , 1715 S. Derexa St., Hamilton
LOUISIANA	(13) <i>Hope E. Schulze</i> , 1801 Short Street, New Orleans	OKLAHOMA	(13) <i>Laurence Ferguson</i> , 2150 S. Cincinnati, Tulsa
MAINE	(14) * <i>Kenneth Sanders</i> , 6 Verdun Street, Fairfield	OREGON	(14) <i>William Griffith</i> , 17507 S. E. Roethe Place, Portland 22
MARYLAND	(14) <i>L. Milton Hause</i> , 2926 Hiss Avenue, Parkville 21234	PENNSYLVANIA	(13) Eastern — <i>Paul Orandosh</i> , 110 S. Hanover St., Pottstown
MASSACHUSETTS	(13) Eastern — <i>George (China) C. McAllister</i> , 517 Washington St., Brighton 35		(13) Western — <i>J. Glenn Weaver</i> , 410 Eaglepoint Blvd., Erie
	(14) Western — <i>Leo H. Burns</i> , 16 Pear St., Springfield		

— Continued —

1964 CONFERENCE AREA DELEGATES

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SOUTH CAROLINA	(14) <i>D.C. (Ceth) Mason, Jr.</i> , 188 King St., Charleston
SOUTH DAKOTA	(14) <i>Jake Steinberg</i> , Box 447, Yankton
TENNESSEE	(14) <i>Wayne Reed</i> , 1110 Bluebird, Memphis
TEXAS	(13) N.E. - <i>Emory E. Richardson</i> , 3112 Rotan Lane, Dallas 29 (14) N.W. - <i>Ralph Gordon</i> , 3317 Fleetwood, Amarillo 79109 (13) S.E. - <i>Ruby Black</i> , 1203 Third Ave., N., Texas City (14) S.W. - <i>S.C. (Tommy) Thompson</i> , P.O. Box 1017, Aransas Pass
UTAH	(13) <i>Bill Coldeway</i> , P. O. Box 18576, Kearns 18
VERMONT	(14) <i>Pete Dewey</i> , P.O. Box 129, Windsor
VIRGINIA	(13) <i>Francis Lineweaver</i> , P.O. Box 809, Staunton
WASHINGTON	(13) <i>Everett A. Kronlund</i> , 6327 16 N.E., Seattle 15
WEST VIRGINIA	(13) <i>George H. Francis</i> , Box 5216, Charleston
WISCONSIN	(14) N. Wisc. & Upper Mich. - <i>Robert Zeugner</i> , 1507 Tenth Avenue, Green Bay (13) Southern - <i>Doug J. McClelland</i> , 735 N. Water St., Suite 908, Milwaukee
WYOMING	(14) <i>David Thompson</i> , Box 163, Cody
PUERTO RICO	(14) <i>Charles Carballo</i> , 306 Lerida St., Urb. Valencia, Rio Piedras

CANADA

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QUEBEC	(14) English - <i>William Burns</i> , 502 Cardinal St., Ville St. Laurent, Montreal (14) French - <i>Robert Roy</i> , 7535 Sagard St., Montreal 35
SASKATCHEWAN	(14) <i>John Tkachuk</i> , 16 Newlands St., Regina

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NORWAY	<i>Hart Sonju</i> , 1117 East Earl St., Philadelphia 25, Pennsylvania
SWEDEN	<i>Axel Skantzze</i> , P.O. Box 16387, Stockholm 16

*Alternate Delegate

BILL'S STATEMENT ON HIS FINANCES

At the 1957 Conference, Bill read to the Delegates the following letter addressed to Mr. Archibald B. Roosevelt, Treasurer of the General Service Board.

Dear Archie,

As many are aware, I have long felt that my personal finances should always be an open book to our membership. Ever since 1951, when the General Service Conference first met, my book royalties and my expense allowances have been shown in each year's audits. This practice will, of course be continued.

This year, however, I would like to make a full accounting for all monies received by me from 1938, when the Alcoholic Foundation was created, to 1955 when, at St. Louis, the Conference and its General Service Board assumed final responsibility for A.A.'s world affairs.

This seventeen-year audit has been prepared by Mr. Wilber Smith, our CPA, and is here enclosed. Saving the small amount I received as a result of Mr. Rockefeller's 1940 dinner, it can be seen that my whole income over those years has derived only from A.A. Publishing activities. My other services to the Headquarters were all volunteer.

I earnestly recommend that this detailed accounting be always shown to every Conference Delegate on request; and further that a copy of this audit be placed on permanent file at the New York Headquarters where, on request, it can be read by any visiting A.A. member.

Ever yours,
Bill
(Signed in full)

WGW/nw
P.S. I hope the Conference sees fit to publish this letter each year in its annual report.

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*Alternate Delegates